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Virginia Board of Education, Business Meeting, Tuesday, December 3, 2024

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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=d2FML2gT_NQ
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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[00:13:14] morning it's 9:00 a.m. and I will now call this meeting to order as is customary for this board we will begin our meeting with a moment of silence

[00:13:22] followed by the Pledge of Allegiance okay is there a motion to approve the

[00:14:04] agenda as presented madam president before we can you just help me I'm speed reading have we added the agenda item to attach address the national board certified teacher I'm satisfied if you tell me it's there that's all I should be there yes great thank you thank you miss Holton miss Ashton miss McPherson miss Kilgore dr. Northern dr. Brice mr. Rotherham and chair

[00:14:43] Bonesa staff has provided members of the board with the draft minutes before the meeting is there a motion to approve the minutes as presented to the board miss it is the pleasure of the board to have with us today students from Albemarle High School I'm gonna ask the board members before we have our performers perform for us if we could get up and go around to the back the back door just to

[00:15:23] stand in the back so that we can see a little bit better the Albemarle High School Orchestra is under the direction of Miss Carrie Finnegan and accompanied by the Albemarle High School principal Mr. Damian Barfield the students performing today represent the Albemarle string ensemble the group is proud of their many accomplishments including superior ratings at district assessment since 2007 first

place and superior ratings at 20 national competitions and performances at the Virginia Music Educators Association conferences Albemarle High School music programs are recognized by the Virginia

[00:16:00] Music Educators Association as one of only eight Virginia schools that have received the Blue Ribbon Award for musical excellence for over 15 years today's performance includes the old boatman by Florence Price and a

[00:16:16] solitary wish by Brian Baumages we're gonna go ahead and move on today the

[00:29:22] board is grateful to be joined by our Milken Educator Award winners very excited to do that it is my honor today to recognize two outstanding Virginia educators selected for the Milken Educator Award today we are joined by Travis Dodds a science teacher at Hanover County's Atlee High School and and Eva Erwin, an English teacher formerly at Alexandria City High School.

[00:29:58] This prestigious recognition highlights their dedication, passion, and excellence that these individuals bring to the classroom every single day. Travis and Eva have shown exceptional commitment to nurturing minds of tomorrow, creating inclusive, innovative learning environments, and inspiring future leaders.

[00:30:22] at this time i would like to invite miss stephanie bishop the vice president of the milken educator foundation in the milken educator awards to the podium to make a presentation followed by travis and eva to the podium to make remarks thank you good morning virginia state board members and superintendent coons and thank you for inviting me to be with you today as you honor the newest Milken Educator Award recipients in Virginia, Travis Dodds of Hanover County, and Eva Irwin

[00:31:01] of Arlington. I am Stephanie Bishop, a 2001 Milken Educator from Virginia. At the time of the award, I was a high school theater teacher in Prince George County, and now Vice President of the Milken Educator Awards, and it is such an honor to be with you today. On behalf of the Milken Family Foundation, I would like to commend the Virginia Department of Education for their support of the Milken Educator Awards program. This school year, the Milken Family Foundation

[00:31:34] is presenting up to 40 Milken Educator Awards across the country, and we look forward to many more surprise announcements in Virginia in the future. I am pleased to share a little about the Milken Educator Awards established by Lowell Milken, chairman and co-founder of the Milken Family Foundation, a nonprofit based in Santa Monica, California.

[00:32:00] Because of Lowell's belief in the importance of educators to students and the future of our society, and a lifelong influence from his own teachers, he conceived and launched the Milken Educator Awards program in 1987 to recognize outstanding K-12 teachers, principals, and specialists that represent the top talent in the profession.

[00:32:27] Since the first awards were presented to 12 educators in California, the foundation has honored almost 3,000 educators coast to coast. It is considered the preeminent teacher recognition program called the Oscars of teaching.

[00:32:47] Virginia joined the Milk and Educator Awards program in 1999, and since then, over a million dollars has been awarded to the greatest asset in the state of Virginia, its educators. The awards provide recognition and unrestricted financial awards to exceptional educators like Travis Dodds and Eva Irwin, who are advancing excellence in Virginia schools.

[00:33:14] This past June, Travis and Eva were welcomed to our national network of excellence at the Milk and Educator Awards Forum in Los Angeles, where they participated in high-powered professional development with other Milk and Educators from across the nation. Great educators such as Travis and Eva do more than instruct. They change lives. Every successful person can name a teacher in their life that made a difference. Even years later, those teachers continue to

[00:33:49] inspire us just through our memories of their example and advice. Milken Award recipients are the ones that this generation's students will remember for years into the future. The obelisks presented to Travis and Eva today are tangible symbols of excellence that send a message to students and the community that society values the work of talented educators. We celebrate successes in schools and to remind educators of the power to make a

[00:34:26] difference in the lives of young people. Now I'd like to ask Travis and Eva to come forward to make a few remarks. Good morning. My name is Travis Dodds and I'm a 2023 Milken educator. First I'd like to thank the board for the recognition this morning and for all you do for the students of Virginia. I'd like to thank Stephanie and the Milken Foundation for this incredible award and all you do for the teachers across this nation. I'd also like to thank my beautiful wife Lindsay for her unwavering support and encouragement throughout the years. The

[00:35:03] day I received my Milken Educator Award was an amazing experience to say the least. It's an experience that I will never ever forget. It was not only a wonderful day for myself but a celebration of and for the entire Atlee community. However, the real honor has not been in what that award, or excuse me, the real honor has been in what that award has meant to me since. Since then, I've had the opportunity to connect with inspiring, passionate educators from across the entire country to share ideas about the future of education, both in the classroom and beyond. This award has been a daily inspiration for me

[00:35:43] and my teaching, and more so, it has encouraged me to activate my leadership potential in ways I never imagined. I hope I can represent this award well in the years to come. Thank you. Good morning. I am honored and grateful to be here today at the Virginia Board of Education meeting, surrounded by like-minded individuals that believe in the power and promise of education in America. It is no secret that there are many challenges right now that educators, students,

[00:36:19] and schools are facing every day. There are obstacles that at times seem insurmountable, but as soon as I was welcomed into the Milken Educator family, I felt an immediate sense of camaraderie and hope for the future of American education. It is powerful to be supported by this passionate community of Milken Educators, but it is not about us. Rather, it is about how we can use our ideas, resources, talents, collaboration, and innovative practices to improve the lives of the students and families that we serve. I always tell my students that education is a powerful tool and no matter what hand they have been dealt in life they can use this tool to build the life that they

[00:36:58] have always dreamed of. I am grateful to the Milken Educator Foundation for helping me to expand my own toolbox. The opportunities, people, and experiences I have gained since March of 2024 I will never take for granted. As educators we have a great responsibility to positively impact the students that we work with, and we cannot take that responsibility lightly.

[00:37:21] I am proud to continue to grow alongside this amazing group of educators and educational leaders in the Milken Foundation. Thank you for believing in me and for encouraging me to always be 10%

bolder in everything that I do. I am very proud to be an educator in the Commonwealth of Virginia, and I am forever honored to be a Milken educator. Thank you. Thank you, Travis, and thank you, Eva,

[00:37:50] and superintendent coons would you do the honor of presenting them with their obelisks we're not

[00:38:44] done yet hold on just a second yes hold on so on behalf of the virginia board of education we are pleased to present you this recognition for your dedication to student success and unwavering commitment to advancing the field of education we are proud of you both and so grateful for your contributions that you make to our schools and to the future of

[00:39:12] Virginia's children. Now board please join now recognize a few of our

[00:40:31] outstanding school division employees for recognition Mr. Rotherham will you be doing our introduction thank you madam president we appropriately recognize teachers given all the work they do and how instrumental it is but I think we all know often students the adult that they connect with the most in the school it might be someone who cleans the school who picks them up in the morning and drives them to school someone in the front office and so it's my great privilege to present the recognizing inspiring school employees the rise award to two exceptional school division employees this morning miss

[00:41:10] Kimber Hill from Harrisonburg City Public Schools and mr. Jimmy Horton from Galax Public Schools have both been named Virginia's 2025 recognizing inspiring school employees the rise award the rise award celebrates the extraordinary dedication and excellence of classified school employees our first recipient is Miss Kimber Hill I kindly ask her to please stand and be recognized miss Hill has devoted more than 21 years to Harrisonburg City Public Schools including 12 years as senior administrative assistant at Harrisonburg High School she's highly regarded for her leadership community

[00:41:49] involvement and her efforts in organizing training events and charity drives. Superintendent Dr. Michael Richards shared that this award not only highlights Ms. Hill's exceptional contributions, but also the lasting and positive impact she's had on the Harrisonburg High School community more generally. Congratulations, Ms. Hill. Next, I'm honored to recognize Mr. Jimmy Horton, and I would ask that he please stand to be recognized. Mr. Horton has been a fleet mechanic with Galax City Public Schools for the past 12 years and has more than 27 years of experience in

[00:42:25] the transportation industry. In addition to his technical expertise, he provides mentoring for students through summer internships, supports his colleagues, and even shares his passion for beekeeping by teaching students about the crucial role that bees play in our environment. As someone who has three very struggling hives at home, I can attest to how difficult that actually is. Superintendent Susan Tilly notes that Mr. Horton truly embodies the spirit of service and excellence that defines the Maroon Tide family, so Roll Tide and congratulations Mr. Horton. On

[00:42:57] On behalf of the Board of Education, I'm going to present to you your recognition as the RISE award winners for your excellence in the areas of work performance, school and community involvement, leadership commitment, student support, and enhancement of classified school employees' image in the communities, schools, and around the Commonwealth.

[00:43:19] Thank you for your unwavering dedication to service, the positive influence you bring to our schools and communities, and I ask everyone to please join me again in congratulating our 2025 RISE recipients.

[00:44:10] I wasn't expecting you to pop up.

[00:44:51] okay now we will move to our computer science educator of the year awards miss Holton are you gonna be this for us well this is such an exciting way to start our day you know we spend a lot of time thinking about things that need improvement but to get to celebrate all the things that are going right in our

[00:45:31] schools is a wonderful way to start the day and our starting with our creativity and collaboration of the five C's this morning with our orchestra all the way through to now getting to honor our Computer Science Educator of the Year who's obviously focused on critical thinking among other skills is a real treat. Today, a week before National Computer Science Education Week, I have the pleasure of introducing to the board Miss Kathleen Fugel, an elementary educator in Fairfax County Public Schools, as this year's 2024 Computer Science Educator of the Year. The Computer Science Educator of the Year

[00:46:07] award recognizes educators for their dedication and excellence in providing high-quality computer science learning experiences. This morning I'm honored to share insights about our honoree as shared during the nomination process. Ms. Fugel has incorporated computer science instruction into every element of her class and note that is elementary school, am I right? Very impressive. She started a computer science week and found different and exciting ways to teach computer science not only to our neurotypical students but for our students who receive special education services to access computer science as

[00:46:43] well. All of these students receive high quality computer science instruction due to Kathleen's passion and ability to differentiate and make the content accessible for all. Your unwavering dedication to every student in computer science is clear and inspiring. Thank You Ms. Fugle. It is now my pleasure to highlight a few of the words from the Board of Education's resolution to recognize you. I won't read it all, but I'll go to "Whereas this acknowledgement serves as a testament to Ms. Fugel's strong dedication to education, learning,

[00:47:18] and commitment to broaden access and provide high-quality computer science education for all students by ensuring computer science instruction to students with disabilities, thereby creating a sense of community and shared purpose within the realm of technological advancement and innovation she serves as leader and inspiration to all educators across the Commonwealth of Virginia and now therefore be it resolved that members of the Board of Education expressed to Miss Fugle their sincere congratulations upon this recognition as a Virginia 2024 computer science educator of the year and extend our

[00:47:55] heartfelt appreciation for your devotion to service okay we have two more items

[00:49:07] before we move into our regular business to proclamations one that miss Kilgore is going to read on computer science education week and then one on family Engagement Month from Dr. Northern. Let me apologize for having my back to most of the audience, but this seems to be the best place to read this. And the print is very fine, so I'm going to have to hold it up like this, okay? This is a certificate of recognition by virtue of the authority vested by the Constitution and the governor of the Commonwealth of Virginia that

[00:49:44] is hereby officially recognized Computer Science Education Week. Whereas every corner of the is connected through the power of computer science, one of Virginia's highest growth industry sectors and

a backbone of Virginia's economy. And, whereas to build a workforce-equipped to support our commonwealth, we must prepare citizens for the needs of an increasingly diverse business climate by providing them the skills and the credentials that are needed in a high-demand technology business.

[00:50:12] And, whereas Virginia boasts an employment concentration in computer science fields that is more than double double the national average, the Commonwealth sees over twice as many online job postings for computer science related positions compared to the nation and growth for these computer science related jobs is projected to exceed 10% over the next five years. And whereas Virginia is proud of its legacy as the first state in the nation to adopt computer science, computational thinking, and coding as essential literacies for all students and the only state to have artificial intelligence through higher education and whereas

[00:50:50] Virginia is home to five lab schools focused on computer science specifically and two lab schools that address information technology career pathways which work to equip students to meet regional high demand skills and whereas the Department of Education has supported the integration of computer science into the k-8 core disciplines and expanding computer science pathways for secondary students underscoring the inherent significance of computer science education including the 2024 adoption of Virginia's computer science standards for students to develop a foundation of computer science knowledge beginning in the earliest grades and whereas the Department of Education has integrated

[00:51:30] computer science into the educational technology plan further emphasizing the importance of computer science education and whereas the Commonwealth of Virginia recognizes the regional partnerships expanded work-based learning and post-secondary and secondary partnerships to expand professional development, high-quality instructional resources, and project-based learning opportunities for educators and students across the Commonwealth through the Advanced Computer Science Education Grant.

[00:51:58] And whereas the Commonwealth of Virginia has developed lab schools to harness partnerships with industry, higher education, and K-12 with some models aimed at increasing exposure and experience in applied computer science outside of school walls. And whereas, National Computer Science Education Week began in 2009 as an annual call to action to inspire K-12 students to learn computer science, promote computer science education, and celebrate their contributors to the field.

[00:52:25] And whereas, this year, Virginia Computer Science Education Week will culminate with Code Virginia hosting an Educator Computer Science Digital Summit and Student Spotlight Campaign, encouraging educators to engage in professional learning and integrate computer science activities into their classrooms and whereas computer science education week officially starts the nomination window for the 2024 computer science education of the year award where parents students and educators can nominate educators across the commonwealth for their contribution and commitment to computer science education and whereas the commonwealth of virginia

[00:53:03] is committed to computer science education by providing all virginia students meaningful access to opportunities in computer science and students classrooms and schools are encouraged to celebrate computer science education week by coming together to explore career pathways and computer science related fields now therefore i glenn youngkin do hereby recognize december 9th through 15th 2024 as computer science education week in our commonwealth of virginia and i call this observance

[00:53:32] to the attention of our citizens signed by our governor glenn youngkin thanks get to wrap it up I think I have a few more, a few fewer whereases than you have, so I have eight whereases.

[00:53:52] I'll call, I'll count them down for you because it kind of culminates. Let's see, family engagement in education month, number eight, whereas parents should sit at the head of the table in their child's education journey, and number seven, whereas family engagement is critical to ensuring a strong home-to-school relationship spanning pre-k to post-secondary education and number six whereas families are essential partners in our teachers in the understanding of learning pathways for students that promote growth proficiency and enthusiasm for learning number five whereas a strong family to school partnership is essential

[00:54:30] now to enable and revitalize student achievement which has significantly declined below pre-pandemic levels and number four whereas positive relationships between families and schools strengthen student outcomes in the communities in which our children live. And four, whereas families, teachers, and schools must commit to ensure that their students attend school every day. And three, whereas schools, school divisions, and school boards are committed to providing necessary and accurate data about students, teachers, and schools to guide and advise parents on the best options for their students. And two, whereas family engagement teams across

[00:55:09] the commonwealth ensure parents are active partners in their children's education and one therefore i glenn youngkin do hereby recognize november 2024 as family engagement and education month in the commonwealth of virginia and call this observance to the education of all education and attention to all of our citizens thank you where is where is todd you you are uh

[00:55:42] ahead of our parent engagement group all right thank you all so much i know we had quite a bit of recognition to do this morning and i i know our orchestra group exited very quietly but i do want to thank once again albemarle high school orchestra for coming this morning to be with us and to start our day off appropriately as we do every one of our meetings we have student

[00:56:20] performances from across the commonwealth and this one was rather special to me because when i first started teaching high school i hung out with the orchestra group and the orchestra teacher and went on several out-of-state orchestra trips with over a hundred kids in an orchestra group as a young teacher and it was um really eye-opening i'll just put it that way but thank you so much to albemarle high school for for being here with us today as we move into the next portion of our meeting is our public comment section and as stated in our board's bylaws

[00:56:58] we accept public comment on all matters related to public education in virginia before we begin i would like to make sure that we have a few comments about the manner in which public comment will be conducted we ask that you model professionalism dignity and respect for others as you share your thoughts today when you begin please provide your name role or affiliation and where you live in virginia all remarks must be directed to the chair you'll notice that you have a timer that you can see on the screen behind me that marks your three minutes the screen will begin to count down at one minute the screen will

[00:57:37] turn yellow the screen will turn red when your time is up please do close your remarks promptly if you have anything written as far as your public comment you may hand it to mr joe crook in the front and he will distribute it to the rest of the board members as soon as possible you may also wish

to email your public comments to the board at b o e at d o e dot virginia spelled out dot gov and so it is my pleasure to begin this morning with reeve bull followed by

[00:58:15] craig herndon please morning madam sharon thank you for the opportunity uh to provide comments to the board this morning my name is reeve bull i'm the director of the office of regulatory management in the governor's office i live in mechanicsville virginia uh and i would like to rise this morning to praise the board of education on the good work to date that is undertaken uh in the regulatory modernization field under governor youngkin's executive order 19. the board has made a very

[00:58:50] good progress in terms of streamlining its regulations as well as its guidance documents so far and the agency also has a very clear plan for next year which will be critical in terms of additional streamlining work for regulations and guidance documents with the goal of achieving a 25 reduction so i really wish to thank the board as well as the department of education team dr coons dr rayleigh jim chapman and the regulatory team for all of their great work to date i realize that this is an arduous process of going through dense regulatory code and identifying reductions.

[00:59:30] And I really appreciate the extraordinary work that's been done. Just to sort of briefly tie this in to sort of broader efforts that are being undertaken in the Commonwealth in the regulatory modernization space. So reductions to date by all Commonwealth agencies have saved Virginia citizens $1.2 billion per year. Agencies have cut To date, 17.6% of the regulatory requirements or streamline those requirements, which represents about 57,000 requirements in total.

[01:00:04] Virginia agencies have also cut 36.1% of their guidance documents, which is 8.6 million words, or I looked it up this morning, roughly 14 times the length of the novel War and Peace. So very, very significant reduction so far.

[01:00:22] These changes make everybody's life easier, including the changes that the board itself has undertaken. One in particular I wanted to highlight is Universal Licensor by Reciprocity. This is helping to expand the teacher supply, help military spouses and others to work in this important field and also expanding the supply of teachers.

[01:00:43] And then just simply simplifying the Virginia Code makes it a lot easier for teachers, administrators, school district and families to navigate. So again, I'm very, very grateful to the board for the great work that is undertaken. Next year will be critical, and so I encourage you to keep up the great work.

[01:01:03] And thanks again for the opportunity to speak this morning. Craig Herndon, followed by Scott Braebrand. Good morning. I'm Madam Chair. Thanks for the chance to say a few words.

[01:01:18] I'm Craig Herndon. I serve as Senior Vice Chancellor for the Community College System in Virginia. I want to acknowledge the Virginia Community College System joins the Board of Education, Virginia Department of Education in placing a high value on academic and career planning. Students who engage meaningfully in exploration of careers, their interests, and their values are well-positioned to succeed in the pursuit of their academic and career plans.

[01:01:41] Virginia Community College System partners with Department of Education in implementing tools that help hundreds of thousands of students in planning for their academic and career plans each year. Virginia Community College System also partners successfully with Virginia Department of

Education and helping students maximize their achievement by allowing to accomplish plans from middle school to high school that lead to post-secondary careers and education.

[01:02:08] The Virginia Community College System, a system of 23 community colleges, provides more than 52,000 high school students from Virginia annually with access to and support in their success in achieving dual enrollment credit on pathways that lead to meaningful post-secondary credentials that align with the students' academic and career plans.

[01:02:28] High school students participating in dual enrollment each year derive benefits as to their family. Those benefits include accelerated college degree completion. It includes insight into college rigor and expectations. It exposes students to college courses, culture, and resources, and provides financial benefit to the students, their families, and the commonwealth.

[01:02:47] Overall, students are well positioned to accelerate their readiness to college and careers by engaging in meaningful academic and career planning. Virginia Community College System is a proud partner in supporting academic and career planning with the Virginia Board of Education and we look forward to our continued partnership with you.

[01:03:03] Thank you. Scott Braebrand followed by Joan Wodiska. Good morning, everyone. President Creasy, members of the State Board of Education and Dr. Koons.

[01:03:19] My name is Scott Braebrand, I'm Executive Director for the Virginia Association of School Superintendents and I live in Lynchburg, Virginia. We are excited to see the next round of school construction grants on the agenda for your review today. We appreciate the addition of regional CTEs for consideration in these grants.

[01:03:37] We also appreciate the urgency to roll out this new round of funding as soon as possible to help superintendents and school divisions as they begin planning for their 20 FY26 budgets for the next school year. We also appreciate your agenda focus on high quality work-based learning as part of the new 3E category in the performance and support framework.

[01:04:00] We agree that apprenticeships, internships, clinical experiences and reimagined school-based enterprises are all great work-based learning opportunities. Providing as much funding and as much support for school divisions and businesses to support these kinds of work-based learning is important and we look forward to continuing to give you some additional support and feedback as we review all the material you have shared with us today.

[01:04:28] While you note in your documents the importance of service learning as a way to learn about work, we ask respectfully that you look at creating criteria where service learning can also be incorporated into a high-quality work-based learning experience. Many of our divisions have high-quality service learning opportunities already in place.

[01:04:48] Your agenda also notes updates to the academic and career plan, which are very appreciated. Discussion of the academic and career plan continues to underscore the importance of school counselors in all of our schools. Please continue to advocate as a board for additional resources to help fund these school counselor positions and for flexible and innovative ways to increase the pipeline for school counselors. We face a shortage of school counselors almost as impactful and almost as serious as the shortage of teachers. We've got to keep thinking out of the box. Finally, we continue to work closely with Dr. Coons and her staff to implement the performance

[01:05:24] and support framework. Maintaining current cut scores on the SOLs will allow VAS to better support our divisions as we implement the framework this school year. Students who are already completing SOL assessments actually for this fall semester courses would be especially impacted by any change now. Clarifying your commitment to this approach as soon as possible is greatly appreciated. As always, VAS looks forward to continuing to partner with you on in this important work. We hope you have a happy holiday and we'll see all of you in the new year.

[01:05:57] Thank you. Joan Wodiska followed by Candace Lucas. Good morning, President Creasy, members of the Board, and Dr. Coons. I'm Joan Wodiska of Falls Church. While I wear several hats, today I come to you in my most important role as a parent to speak in strong support of item K. A few years ago, our daughter set a goal to earn an IB diploma and join Jay Ratzi. The catch for her to graduate with an IB diploma and participate in J.Rotze, she would need to take several summer classes over

[01:06:32] several years to earn that diploma. In her conversation, she asked me why doesn't Virginia recognize an IB diploma like other states or the world? And why did she have to take PE when J.Rotze instruction included rigorous health, wellness, and physical training?

[01:06:49] Now teenagers are really good at keeping us on our toes as parents. Item K is the answer to her questions, and the flexibility and academic credit Virginia students continue to need today. First, for J. ROTC students and families, our Commonwealth is home to more than 20 active military bases and commands, including the world's largest naval installation, Norfolk Naval Station, the Marine Corps Quantico, and even the Pentagon. And given this military connection, Virginia boasts a strong and proud ROTC community. Item K would allow ROTC participation to fulfill

[01:07:25] The high school PE requirement not just for the Army is currently allowed in Virginia, but for all branches, including the newest addition, Space Force. Virginia is fortunate to boast one of only 10 junior ROTC Space Force programs in the nation, and our daughter is a proud graduate of the program.

[01:07:47] Second, for IB course takers and IB diploma candidates, item K adds IB courses to the state-approved high school course list. the inclusion of the IB courses will empower students and families to make critical high school course selections together. Given Virginia's new monetary investment into IB tests, it is timely to add more courses to the approved list. Further, given the state's financial investment, item K also critically clarifies that Virginians who earn an IB diploma will also earn an advanced diploma without having to take coursework beyond the IB diploma requirements.

[01:08:24] This simple clarification could have saved our daughter three summers of unnecessary classes. Lastly, Item K adjusts the dates to afford all high school students, including those currently 9th to 12th grade, and any new families moving into our thriving commonwealth, equal opportunity and access to a high school diploma. While these changes will not benefit our daughter, Item K will unlock academic freedom award credit and offer new opportunities to countless virginia

[01:08:56] students and for this i sincerely thank you for your action and leadership candace lucas followed by wendy little candace lucas wendy little followed by tammy c greetings oh can y'all hear me

[01:09:34] greetings mrs creasy um and everyone else here um no offense intended but i i do plan to use my first amendment rights in full today potentially i just want to quickly before i start my name is wendy little also known as aaron's mom across the united states of virginia i say that again united states as well as all of virginia on your rules changes there needs to be some idea language faith still must be provided for

students with suspensions also the school division must change records and make records appropriate when children have validated attendance

[01:10:13] reasons. This is why they keep kicking kids out of school with special education, kicking them out and charging us with truancy over and over again. So like they did to Aaron Little. Um, but I'm here to also tell you very quickly that BDOE doesn't want to give me any credit. BD Chesterfield County refused to educate my son. It was adjudicated twice. BDOE did not in fact come in and do corrective actions within the 30 days when it was supposed to. So out of desperation the day after my breast cancer surgery, December 4th last year, December 5th, I went to legislative executive session begging for help from somebody who would listen. We have HB 1089, special education reform, because I

[01:10:52] did that, because nobody was listening to my son and VDOE was not doing corrective actions, so you're out of compliance. So I also wanted to mention that Ms. Halton had brought up to the impact of what does it mean on one of your policies and your own VDOE, which I will leave for you, does state that you have responsibilities. And you are in clear violation of the following U.S. codes. 34 CFR 300 149

[01:11:25] RE CAEA responsibility for general supervision. 34 CFR 300.227 regarding direct services by the

[01:11:35] SCA. Ms. Coons, where's Aaron's education? What are y'all doing? Doing nothing. 20 USC, 1414 G&H, direct services by the SCA. That's you all. Yeah, you're out of federal compliance with that. We are on year three, my son has no education due to tricks and stunts pulled by things. Your video, we even acknowledges the policy that you referenced, Ms. Holton, about the responsibilities. And there's a document called Aaron Little procedures, drafted by

[01:12:14] sans anderson this is completely illegal this is what goes on in school divisions that keep our kids out of school constantly charging us with neglect and truancy and all kinds of other things and it's lisa coons fault you failed to protect aaron little and caused us to have to be dragged through the mud you are responsible thank you thank you miss little tammy c followed

[01:12:41] by kathy halverson tammy c here followed by kathy halverson is kathy here Thomas Moran, followed by Dan Zacharias, it's Thomas Moran here, Dan Zacharias, followed by Tina Makhlamot, Manglic-Mott.

[01:13:19] Good morning, Madam Chair, members of the board. I'm Dan Zacharias. I'm the director of the Old Dominion Association of Church Schools. You have received comment from me before in the past, so we're familiar.

[01:13:37] I live in the Shenandoah Valley, and this morning I'd like to do just a thought exercise, if I may. Imagine, in your mind, a private school in Virginia. I represent some Baptist church-run schools, but it could be non-religious.

[01:13:59] Religious works really good for the thought exercise. It could be any of a wide variety. We have a wide variety of private schools in our commonwealth. And let's say that this school serves students in grades kindergarten through 12. Does a licensing official from the Virginia Department of Education have any purview to walk into that school and do an inspection for safety or for academic quality or anything like that?

[01:14:31] Well, the answer is no. And I've been coming to these meetings for many years. Mr. Rotherham can attest to that. He remembers me sitting in the meetings a long, long time ago. And to my knowledge, that's not a problem.

[01:14:46] It still is not a problem, never has been a problem. Is there an effort to compel private schools or religious schools to align their curriculum with the standards of learning? Well, no, the answer's no. But if you just back up from a five-year-old class to a four-year-old class, suddenly the picture changes dramatically.

[01:15:10] And so, and in our schools, very often, those two classrooms are side by side on the same hallway. Their doors are right next to each other. And an inspector has the right to come in inspect this class and not this one and these inspectors are becoming more aggressive and in some cases bemoaning the lack of authority that they have in the K to 12 grades and so there's a there's a serious problem in our view there's a serious conflict in Virginia policy that we're deeply concerned about that affects us and we are in the we've tried some legislation last year that was

[01:15:50] the impetus for HB 222 and Senate excuse me Senate Bill 76 so we just want you to make be aware of our concerns we thought years ago if if purview was shifted from DSS to the DOE for early childhood that that could mean more freedom for our preschools in the same way as our k-12 schools but the opposite has been the case and I've talked to you about the safety issue many times as well so thank you for your time Merry Christmas and have a good day.

[01:16:27] Tina Manglemont followed by Alan Siebert. Good morning President Creasy, Dr. Cairns, and members of the State Board of Education. My name is Dr. Tina Manglemont and I proudly served Virginia Public Schools for 24 years as a teacher, a leader, and a former director at VDOE. These days I live in Newport News Virginia, and I lead Code VA, a statewide nonprofit education that we're dedicated to training teachers and out-of-school time providers to educate, innovate, and elevate student learning

[01:17:06] in computer science and STEM. I also serve as the Executive Director of the Commonwealth Learning Partnership, where we partner with professional organizations, institutions of higher education, and our school divisions to study redesign of our school systems in order to put students at the center of their learning, empowering them to build durable skills and align academic and career interests. I'm here today to voice my support and appreciation to Dr. Koons and her team's work on early career exploration and academic career plans. This approach sets our schools up for

[01:17:42] success in preparing our young adults for high school and to make sure that they're ready to graduate for the for the threes. As a STEM and computer science leader, I see barriers that limit diverse participation in advanced courses. Too often, these opportunities feel out of reach for students outside the white male majority, leaving many young people unaware of careers in STEM and computer science until it's too late for them to fully explore them. Early career exploration breaks down the barriers, it expands possibilities for all students, and it promotes economic

[01:18:18] and social stability. By sparking curiosity in our elementary students and equipping them with foundation skills to persist through career pathways, we can help them envision broader futures. Research underscores the need for this early engagement to address the workforce needs in Virginia.

[01:18:37] The proposed career exploration redesign, our renewed focus on the five C's, and academic and career plan templates are vital steps toward creating a true pipeline from early exposure at the

elementary school to middle school engagement all the way through graduation.

[01:18:57] Lastly, I would be remiss if I did not advocate for additional resources to support academic and career plans. School counselors are vital to their success with staff shortages. We need to innovate and be creative in our solutions. We need to rethink the school day to give teachers time to expand their understanding of careers beyond education and the time to help students connect their learning to their academic plans good ideas are just the beginning success lies and how it's brought to life thank you for your time today and for your continued commitment to

[01:19:31] providing students the durable skills they need to thrive and work and in life alan siebert followed by josh singer president creasy members of board dr coons my name is alan siebert i serve as constituent services and government relations officer in roanoke city public schools we want to thank you for the work you do on behalf of children the volunteer work you do have children families in the commonwealth and to support those in the divisions who do the work regarding the virginia literacy act we are truly appreciative that virginia legislators and policy makers are committed to the science of reading and are working to provide the resources necessary to

[01:20:07] ensure highly effective instruction for all learners on behalf of the roanoke city public school board and dr white our superintendent i'm asking the state superintendent state board to approve the roanoke city public schools literacy plan for the last two years of our five-year contract and approval established per your unanimous vote in your meeting a year ago december 12 2023 item n core program said to approve and direct the superintendent public instruction to create an appeals process by which local school divisions currently using curriculum they believe successful to come to the superintendent and the board for that approval in rogsey public schools we not only believe that our curriculum is successful but the attached

[01:20:46] results also prove that it is student outcomes that resulted in rcps being highlighted in September 24 when we hosted the right to read rent for our region and we are honored to host Dr. Coons, Dr. Solari and our legislators. The VLA has been transformative in the Commonwealth, but RCPS was among our divisions that implemented the science of reading before the VLA was ever drafted.

[01:21:08] Please do not punish your pioneers who helped champion the VLA and the General Assembly and just because we were leading the way. During the 2021 school year, in accordance with our strategic plan, our division researched, procured trained teachers and implemented really great reading combined with wit and wisdom to provide a comprehensive sequential systematic explicit and cumulative literacy program that is entirely consistent with science-based reading research and the virginia sols that effort included a 1.8 million dollar investment in a five-year contract in the years since we have embraced the work of the general assembly and the board and have continued to augment our program

[01:21:44] as the attached chart appeal and supporting documents illustrate we check all the boxes required by the VLA. We're in the third year of a five-year contract and are relentlessly working to ensure fidelity of implementation of evidence-based programs where every RCPS reading teacher has been trained to execute. Not approving the RCPS literacy plan could cost our division millions of dollars, but much worse negatively impacts students currently benefiting from already established science reading programs in RCPS. We are committed to continuous improvement and our contract is up for renewal. We will evaluate materials and resources explicitly adopted for the VLA, a truly transformative act that came after a small number of divisions like

[01:22:24] RCPS were already implementing the science of reading. Please prevent the disruption of learning for thousands of students and wasting millions of local dollars by granting the RCPS appeal, including the materials provided. Please authorize Dr. Coons to approve our plan. This is in the purview of the State Board. Thank you. Josh Singer followed by Gene Sokolowski. Good morning, Madam Chair, members of the Board, and Superintendent Coons. My name is Josh Singer and I serve as the

[01:23:02] IB Diploma Program Coordinator at Meridian High School. On behalf of Falls Church City Public Schools and the students and families in our community, we want to thank the Board of Education for the proposed changes identified in item K and ask for their adoption as written. Both the Virginia Profile of a Graduate and the IB Learner Profile share aspirations to prepare students with the knowledge, skills, and attributes essential for success in the modern world.

[01:23:31] The Commonwealth's Profile of a Graduate is a phenomenal framework for our public schools. It raises the bar for our young people and ensures they are ready to be productive members of our 21st century society. Similarly, the IB Learner Profile identifies 10 core traits, including knowledgeable, communicators, inquirers, and principal.

[01:23:55] These traits are central to all IB programs in reaching their goal of developing young people into responsible members of local and national communities. This alignment makes the board's proposed recognition of IB Diploma candidates welcomed. Virginia's IB Diploma candidates meet rigorous academic requirements and are some of the most academically prepared and challenged high school students in the world.

[01:24:17] Based on data, IB students are admitted to prestigious universities at greater rates, IB students are more likely to persevere through on-time graduation than their non-IB peers. For their efforts, they are well deserving of qualifying for the Virginia Advanced Studies Diploma with no additional requirements.

[01:24:36] Yet one of the more significant challenges students face has nothing to do with the rigors of the IB Diploma. It's ensuring that students' schedules meet the requirements for the Virginia Advanced Studies Diploma AND the IB Diploma. Frequently, IB students must take additional coursework online or in the summer to meet both sets of requirements.

[01:24:57] Most impacted by the existing Virginia requirements are the students of those families who serve our country honorably in our Armed Services or State Department. Their children take IB coursework while attending IB schools around the world and then have to complete up to four additional classes on top of their diploma courses upon enrollment in the Commonwealth schools.

[01:25:20] Regardless of circumstance, the existing system places undue burdens on students and their families, forcing them into difficult and sometimes financially strenuous situations. Finally, we greatly appreciate the board's proposed inclusion of IB coursework on the list of approved high school courses.

[01:25:38] This will ensure students and families like the 93% of Meridian's Class of 2025 are aware of the choice to enroll in IB courses in all of Virginia's 73 IB world schools.

[01:25:54] In updating the BOE guidance regarding graduation requirements, the Board would take the necessary steps to recognize the academic achievement of an IB diploma and remove regulations for students. Thank you. We urge strong support for item K as presented.

[01:26:10] Thank you. Gene Sokoloski followed by Deanna Lieberman.

[01:26:30] Dr. Gene Sokoloski, Woodbridge, grandparent, Madam Chair, Virginia Code requires the board to, quote, seek to ensure that the standards of learning are consistent with a high-quality foundation educational program, unquote. The board failed to do this with standard WHII 10D in the 2023 standard, excuse me, history and social science standards of learning, which it approved after I informed it in my 12 March 2023 email that the standard was grossly flawed. This standard requires the student to, quote, explain the collapse of communism in the Soviet Union and Eastern Europe and the end of the Cold

[01:27:09] War, including the actions of Mikhail Gorbachev, Pope John Paul II, Ronald Reagan, Margaret Thatcher, and Vaclav Havel, unquote. There are two serious issues here. The first issue is the standard says communism collapsed in the Soviet Union before it did in Eastern Europe. This is false. It was the other way around. The second issue is that Vaclav Havel of Czechoslovakia is presented as the key figure in the collapse of communism in Eastern Europe. This is both false and offensive. It was Poland's nine-year-long solidarity movement led by Lech Wałęsa that began the collapse of communism

[01:27:43] in Eastern Europe. Solidarity was a social movement that began in August 1980 and quickly grew to 10 million people. Solidarity leaders were imprisoned, but the movement continued as an underground organization led in considerable part by Polish women.

[01:27:59] After nine years of tyrannical rule and multiple solidarity deaths, the communist authorities relented, and on June 4, 1989, partially free elections were held. Solidarity candidates won all possible seats in the lower house and 99 out of 100 seats in the Senate.

[01:28:16] Three months later, in November of '89, the nonviolent Velvet Revolution occurred in Czechoslovakia over a 12-day period. and in December '89, Vaclav Havel became president. Some obvious questions are, why is Vaclav Havel presented as the key figure in the collapse of communism in Eastern Europe when in fact it was Lech Fawenza who on the advisory board wrote this grossly flawed standard?

[01:28:39] Was it because of incompetence or intent? Was it the same committee member who falsified two of the four victim groups of genocide in the 2015 standards of learning that prevented students from learning that Pols and Romani were also Hitler's genocide victims?

[01:28:55] Was it the same committee member who in the 2023 standards of learning excluded Poles and Romani as Hitler's genocide victims? Do you see a pattern here? These examples are not the high quality education Virginia code requires you to, excuse me, to ensure.

[01:29:11] I respectfully request that you investigate the committee member who wrote this flawed standard and determine if it was intent or incompetence. I further request you correct this standard by inserting the name Lechvenza in place of Glav Havel. Thank you. Deanna Lieberman followed by Hakeem Fung. Good morning and thank you for the opportunity to speak today. My name is Dr. Deanna Lieberman. I am the District IB Specialist for Fairfax County

[01:29:49] Public Schools, which has 23 IB programs, including eight IB high schools. I live in Falls Church and I am speaking on behalf of Fairfax County Public Schools today. We wish to voice our strong support for the IB items included in item K, the proposed update to approved courses for graduation requirements. We support the identification and recognition of IB courses that provide increased access to both standard and advanced diplomas for our students. These updates are likely to increase the number of our IB schools offering these courses: Sports, Exercise and Health Science, Design Technology, and Global Politics, which will expand

[01:30:28] equity and access to rigorous advanced academic courses for all of our students. Furthermore, this provides more options for students to take courses in areas of interest or strength, which may lead to career goals as well as earn them college credit.

[01:30:46] We also support the item stating that IB Diploma students be deemed to have earned the Advanced Diploma. In addition to recognizing the rigor of the IB Diploma, this eases the burden on our counselors and our IB Coordinators, who have had to complete complicated logic puzzles to ensure IB Diploma candidates earn the advanced diploma.

[01:31:07] We have had many complaints in the past regarding these difficulties. I thank you very much for the opportunity and I thank you for creating this item and supporting our IB schools in Fairfax County and the state of Virginia.

[01:31:24] Hakeem Fung followed by Julie Brown. Good morning.

[01:31:40] My name is Hakeem Fung and I'm an educator living in Chesterfield, Virginia. I wanted to bring up a request that the Virginia Department of Education substitute SOL test list be updated for the new standards for the 2023 Mathematics S.W.O.L. Framework and the 2018 Science S.W.O.L. Framework. There are many tests still on the S.W.O.L. Substitute list that are either outdated or needs to be updated to reflect the newer standards.

[01:32:03] For example, the new IB mathematics tests are not currently listed on the S.W.O.L. Substitute list, whereas the previous mathematics tests for IB prior to the current ones were able to be used not only for math verified credit, but also for as an SS substitute test for federal accountability for students who pass Algebra 1, Geometry, and Algebra 2 in middle school. Throughout the life of the SOL substitute test list, the cut scores for CLEP exams have also shifted. For example, the CLEP college algebra test, the cut score for verified credit shifted downwards from a score of 30 for the 2009 Algebra 1 standard to a score of 28 for the 2016 standards, what would

[01:32:41] be the established score for the more rigorous 2023 standards. Another example was when the CLEP chemistry cut score for a substitute verified credit was shifted upwards from a 30 to a 33 in the 2010 chemistry as well revisions in 2014, whereas CLEP biology has remained the same at 30.

[01:33:00] What would be a new cut score for the 2018 science standards for CLEP chemistry or CLEP biology test? Having an up-to-date as well as substitute list that reflects the new 2018 science standards and the new 2023 math standards is crucial for schools across Virginia to have an up-to-date tool to support their students.

[01:33:19] If scores for CLEP or other substitute tests are going up, staying the same are going down and up-to-date as well as substitute list is needed so that schools can plan ahead for the more up-to-date and rigorous as well framework and force students to understand their options and meeting graduation requirements thank you Julie Brown followed by Valenta Wade good morning President Creasy members of the Virginia Board of Education and Superintendent Coons my name is dr. Julie Brown I get the privilege of

[01:33:57] serving as the vice president of advanced learning for the Institute for Advanced Learning and Research located in Danville Virginia and I'm a proud resident of Pennsylvania County. I'm here today and honored to give testimony to the importance of early career exposure. I actually have a picture of member Holton on a bulldozer at one of our Career Expo events many years ago. We know that middle school early

career exposure can significantly impact students academic motivation, career aspirations, and long-term success.

[01:34:30] Research confirms the importance of introducing career exploration early, as it not only helps students understand their interests and their strengths, but also improves their academic performance. It provides access to valuable mentorship and it reduces stereotypes. Ultimately, early career exploration helps students of all backgrounds gain the knowledge, skills, skills and confidence to pursue meaningful career paths.

[01:34:59] We have actualized this across 54 middle schools in the Commonwealth of Virginia through the expansion of our great opportunities in technology and engineering careers, affectionately known as the GoTech program, is now again started in three middle schools and is now available in 54 middle schools across the Commonwealth of Virginia.

[01:35:21] The investment that was made through public-private partnership has allowed us to put technology-relevant, industry-critical equipment into those middle schools to give 11-year-olds minds-on, hands-on learning experiences that are connected to the industries that we support in our region.

[01:35:41] For students that are struggling in math, there's no better way to help them understand Cartesian coordinates than to let them start using a 3D printer or a milling machine. When students start to build something, whether it's through additive or subtractive manufacturing, that mathematical concept comes to life.

[01:35:59] We have 11-year-olds that understand five-dimensional space because they've been enabled to build something or mill it down through a process. So these programs are really intended to support manufacturing broadly, and that's for the maritime industry, pharmaceutical industry, biotech, Food and Beverage Manufacturing, Aerospace Automative.

[01:36:23] Again, this is a nine-week curriculum, and we are proud to be partnering with the Virginia Department of Education, their Career and Technical Education Division, to add three CTE courses to the middle school experience. That will double the number of CTE opportunities for young people in the Commonwealth of Virginia.

[01:36:41] So we are thrilled, and we ask for your continued support and expansion of Career and Technical Education. all of virginia's students should be career and technical education students thank you valenta wade followed by elizabeth's site card good morning my name is valenta wade i'm the manager of testing for rich and public schools and i also serve as their division director of testing but today i'm here as a autism mom and a concerned citizen living in herraco county public in herraco county district i want to address my concerns regarding the vat participation

[01:37:17] criteria tool and the unintended consequences it has created. While the tool itself is effective in identifying students with cognitive disabilities who would benefit from an alternate curriculum, we are facing significant challenges due to the recent transition.

[01:37:35] Across the state, there are students who no longer qualify for VAP, but are now required to be taught the standards of learning as it is written. students have spent years under the VAB curriculum and this abrupt shift has left them without adequate support to bridge the knowledge gaps they have formed of no uh gas of no fault of their own we have been instructed to update accommodations to support these

students however many of these accommodations do not address the foundational knowledge knowledge deficits caused by years of

[01:38:10] following an alternate curriculum without proper interventions we risk setting these students up for continued frustration and failure which is deeply concerning while i understand and appreciate the intent behind the vat participation criteria tool we must be intentional about addressing the unattended consequences without immediate action these students will face unnecessary barriers to success i urge the board to consider the following solutions to ensure equity fairness and opportunity for all virginia students number one transition plan for development implement a phased transition

[01:38:49] plan for support moving from vap to sol instruction these should include targeted instructional interventions tailored remediation programs and additional resources to help bridge the knowledge gap to enhance professional development provide educators with intensive training on how to scaffold instruction effectively for students transitioning from vap to sol this could include strategies for differentiation of instruction integration of universal design for learning principles and addressing special specific learning gaps number three flexible assessment models

[01:39:24] consider offering modified assessments aligned with sol content but tailored to the needs of of students transitioning from VAP. And then number four, family and student support. Develop a system of family and student support, such as extended learning opportunities, tutoring programs, and counseling to ensure both academic and emotional needs are addressed during this transition period.

[01:39:45] Thank you for your time and support.

[01:39:50] - Elizabeth Seip Card, followed by Melissa Johnston.

[01:40:31] - Good morning. Elizabeth Seip Card from Woodbridge, Virginia. Deafness is different for everyone. I am grateful for cued.

[01:40:47] Virginia code preserves the right to use cued speech. My son has had teachers and specialists acting in good faith. One school year a CLT was in person for him. A paid position is posted by the county, but it has not been filled for three years.

[01:41:04] Why? What can I do? The three takeaways for today. Learn to cue, access by ear, and three to four years left. Learn cued speech to have it taught in schools statewide because there is an in-person CLT shortage statewide.

[01:41:22] Sign language is taught in schools. So, then teach cue, the modality, for application of cued language, like cued American English, cued Spanish, et cetera. He would need a CLT to comprehend ASL. Languages are in and of themselves languages.

[01:41:39] That will not change. Cued speech is the modality used for him as a portal to access spoken and visual languages and communicate. As a parental eyewitness at Opening Doors Unlocking Potential Conference, specialists avoid learning it and make excuses that their kid does not use it.

[01:41:57] That is discrimination. General educators should learn it, then teach it and use it too. Host a recruiting interval program statewide for acute candidates. There should be as many in-person CLTs as there are crossing guards. While there is a mandate to ban cell phones, there is bullying against those who need exceptions.

[01:42:17] Have a special color like crossing guard belts for allowing phones and encourage the normal range hearing kids to learn to cue in order to help the deaf and keep their phones too. Those would be incentives and rewards for learning to cue and potentially pay to fill needed spots in the future or to grow and cue speech to him.

[01:42:36] Make the certification process easier. Those who get certified to sign must also learn and practice to be certified to cue to be versatile. If this already exists, who is enforcing it for accountability? Access by ear. I support my child in school. I cannot hear what he misses. People talk to him without three rotating virtual CLTs around, so I asked the school teachers if he could audio record. Some said yes, some said no. Central office said no. I need a unanimous yes, especially in lieu of no in-person CLTs and in the future academic use.

[01:43:09] I asked for a moving desk and they said no. I asked for retention and they said no. There's a Zoom call, but there's no CLT in person for PE or after-school activities like robotics or bus rides. Three to four years left. Delegate. Volunteer. Tell someone. Voluntel.

[01:43:25] I have been told the money is there for training. We need more normal-range hearing people. In summary, it is a bipartisan issue and state problem. His school will not let him record. We have things like wheelchairs, parking spaces, but we need people. We need mass dissemination of learning cued speech by normal hearing range people as delegated.

[01:43:45] Thank you so much. Melissa Johnston, followed by Stacey Gordon. Good morning. My name is Melissa Johnston.

[01:44:07] I have served as a teacher at Thomas Jefferson High School for 22 years, 13 of which have been as the IB Diploma Program Coordinator there. I'm a Chesterfield County resident. I'm speaking today in support of expanding access to the Virginia Advanced Studies Diploma by recognizing students who have completed all of the requirements of the IB Diploma.

[01:44:31] The International Baccalaureate Program is unique in that its assessment model includes both school-supported, individual, inquiry-driven practical work and exams rich in multi-step data-based analysis. Most significantly, students interrogate their subjects through research and writing across the disciplines. Full diploma candidates must balance this challenging academic load with weekly participation in a program they develop for themselves consisting of community service, athletic or fitness activities, and creative endeavors. For a few years now, the IB programs

[01:45:10] at Thomas Jefferson have followed an inclusive IB for all philosophy. Our middle years program includes all students in 9th and 10th grades. All students have the option to take one or more courses in the diploma program and we have planned course sequencing to provide a path to the full IB diploma for as many students as possible. One of the aspects of my work is to collaborate with our school counseling department to determine the options incoming students have for diploma program coursework while still meeting the specific course requirements for the Virginia Advanced

[01:45:45] studies diploma sometimes we barely thread the needle other students miss out i'm sorry pardon me every year we seem to have one or more students who need to pick up coursework through virtual virginia or summer school to complete requirements for both diplomas other students miss out on the opportunity to engage with and benefit from the full scope of this advanced curriculum because we

cannot bridge the differences between the two certifications This is especially true when students transfer to our school in 10th or 11th grade.

[01:46:16] We have had full diploma candidates transfer from out-of-state who could not finish the full IB diploma because they needed to recoup coursework for the Virginia Advanced Studies diploma. This really is an equity issue and an appropriate education for many students includes the opportunity to engage and challenge themselves with an advanced curriculum.

[01:46:35] Some currently miss the chance to do so to complete general coursework to ensure the awarding of their Virginia diploma. I urge you to improve student access to an appropriate education by diversifying the routes that lead to a Virginia Advanced Studies diploma and voting to adopt the provisions for doing so found in item K. Thank you for your time.

[01:46:55] Stacy Gordon followed by Isabella Villano. Good morning, Madam Chair, members of the Board. My name is Stacy Gordon representing the Virginia Manufacturers Association and I'm here this morning to speak to Jeanette Img, the academic and career period guideline update.

[01:47:13] We appreciate the board's efforts to refine and enhance the academic and career plan guidelines and the version that you'll consider today, we consider a big step in the right direction. However, we do believe the framework requires more attention to realize its full potential and that additional steps are necessary to address critical gaps in implementation.

[01:47:31] Specifically, we've observed the career exploration and readiness requirements outlined in Virginia Code are not being consistently met across the Commonwealth, and to better support students and educators in achieving these goals, we strongly recommend the following actions. Number one, overhaul the ACP webpage and integrate technology.

[01:47:50] The department's academic and career plan website requires a comprehensive redesign to serve as an intuitive, centralized, and technology-driven resource hub. A modernized platform should integrate standardized career exploration tools that highlight industry-recognized credentials relevant to key economic sectors in Virginia, Promote experimental learning opportunities, such as co-ops, apprenticeships, and internships, and encourage dual-enrollment pathways.

[01:48:16] And two, standardize and broaden career exploration resources. Uniform, accessible, and engaging resources are essential to ensuring equity and career readiness across all school divisions. These resources must not only meet the baseline expectations, but must also inspire students to explore diverse career paths and equip them with the tools to make informed decisions about their futures.

[01:48:38] The success of the ACP depends on its ability to effectively bridge the gap between K-12 education and post-secondary opportunities, including workforce training, technical education, and higher education. By implementing these recommendations, Virginia can strengthen its commitment to preparing students to the challenges and opportunities of the 21st economy.

[01:48:58] We stand ready to collaborate with the Virginia Department of Education and other stakeholders to bring these recommendations to fruition. Together, we can ensure students have the tools and resources they need to succeed in their academic and career pursuits. Thank you very much. - Isabella Volano followed by Jill Cruz.

[01:49:19] - Morning, my name is Isabella Volano and I'm a freshman at VCU studying chemistry and pharmaceutical sciences. I'm here today as a student in support of item K. I graduated in 2024 from Meridian High School in Falls Church City with an IB diploma. And as I have transitioned in my college coursework, I have been able to experience firsthand just how much the IB courses have effectively prepared me to take on that new load.

[01:49:42] Through these challenging and rigorous courses, I learned how to plan, organize, and write 2,000 to 3,000 word essays, manage my time effectively with a heavy course load in addition to extracurriculars outside of school, and how to problem-solve when faced with challenges that seem impossible. These skills and knowledge I have gained from the IB program have significantly made my transition to higher education less overwhelming and confusing, and have allowed me to continue to grow as I continue my education.

[01:50:09] I urge the Board to adopt Item K because it supports the most challenging education and will allow more students to get credit for courses towards the Virginia Advanced Diploma. Thank you for your time. Thank you. Jill Cruz.

[01:50:27] Good morning. My name is Jill Cruz and I live in Falls Church City. Thank you for the opportunity to address all of you today. I'm here to strongly encourage the Virginia State Board of Education to vote in favor of Item K. My husband is a U.S. Foreign Service Officer and our children have grown up in the Foreign service spending most of their lives abroad. We returned to Virginia in August of 2024 for the first time in seven years and our son is a high school junior pursuing the International Baccalaureate diploma. Regrettably, under current rules our son will have to take several additional courses on top of an already

[01:51:04] vigorous IB diploma program in order to fulfill current Virginia graduation requirements. These additional courses include US and Virginia history, U.S. government and civics, among others. If he had been in Virginia throughout his life, he would have had these courses in previous years, but because of our family service overseas, he was not able to take these courses, and now he's compelled to take them in addition to the very intensive IB diploma program requirements, attempting to fit them into holiday breaks, summer, and alongside his schedule, which includes four higher-level IB classes.

[01:51:40] Having grown up as part of a diplomatic family overseas, our children have rich experiences and have taken classes that cover history, social studies, government, politics, and culture that have led to a comparative and deep understanding of these topics in a global context.

[01:51:57] As I understand it, Virginia law allows for the children of U.S. military families who move to the Commonwealth to be exempt from requirements for classes that they would normally have taken in prior academic years. That law recognizes the challenges inherent in the frequent moves required of a career spent in service to our country. As members of the U.S. Foreign Service, our family has experienced the same challenges as we have moved all over the world in service to our country and our children have changed schools multiple times. I ask that you vote in favor of item K, ensuring that students who complete requirements for the International Baccalaureate

[01:52:33] Diploma shall be deemed to have completed the requirements for a Virginia Advanced Diploma. Thank you for taking up this important issue and for giving it your highest consideration. you I'm gonna circle back now with people who are not here that had signed up Candace Lucas Tammy see

Kathy Halverson Thomas Moran okay if there are any others in the audience that would like to speak you can line up behind the

[01:53:11] podium please good morning members of the board and superintendent Coons I'm here today as a parent of two Arlington public school students first I wanted to thank you for the new school accountability framework and releasing the data publicly on it.

[01:53:36] improvement it is for tran versus the prior opaque s stress the importance eno an equitable website for compare schools. The curr quality profiles deserves trash heap of history alo parallel state report car accreditation. The civil r League gave school quality profiles its lowest rating in their equity scorecard, stating it provides, quote, nothing in terms of format or usability with the end user in mind, end quote.

[01:54:13] National expert Morgan Polikoff also just led a study of state school report cards, and they mistakenly thought the front page on accreditation contained the federal ESSA data. If one of the top accountability experts in the country can't understand school quality profiles, how on earth are regular parents supposed to understand it? Third, the Northern Virginia School Board chairs in calling for a delay are desperate to avoid having a transparent accountability system that empowers parents like Maryland schools have just a few miles from us.

[01:54:46] These people were fine with the prior opaque system that didn't hold anyone accountable, which is why they're calling for it to continue. Most importantly, almost everything in this new system is things these school systems have been focused on for decades. Getting kids to mastery, having kids growing academically, making sure kids go to school, having kids who are ready to take algebra in middle school take it, and preparing kids for life after high school.

[01:55:11] What is delay actually about? Arlington now reported that Arlington School Legislative Director said they settled on this delay strategy because they didn't think repeal would be successful this legislative session. Talk about saying the quiet part out loud. Lastly, I've written publicly probably the most of anyone in the state on the new system. I'm a proud Obama Democrat. President Obama was vocal about the need for accountability and high academic standards.

[01:55:38] Northern Virginia is full of the same types of parents, which is why I've had tons of Nova Democrats, Democratic parents reach out to me, telling me how much more useful the new system is and thanking me for speaking up. I have a new article out this morning with a Democratic parent from Alexandria who's thankful for the new middle school math factor because Alexandria quietly eliminated the path for algebra in seventh grade last year because of a warped definition of equity.

[01:56:04] Our message to you is stay the course and know that tons of Democratic parents from Northern Virginia are behind you on this issue. Thank you. Good morning. I hope you were all inspired by the music that we started the day with.

[01:56:23] That was as rough as your day gets. I hope that that carries you a long way. My name is Derek Max. I'm the president of the Thomas Jefferson Institute for Public Policy. I'm an economist by training. I apologize for that. I worked in Congress on the Education and Labor Committee.

[01:56:38] I was a co-author of the Education and Crossroads Report. And I'm also a school founder 25 years ago. My wife and I founded Cornerstone School in Washington, D.C. And I was its principal for eight years. I rise today in favor of the new framework school performance and support. And as an economist

you won't be surprised to hear me say that data is your friend. I would also want you to know that data that differentiates is always better than data that groups. And lastly, I want you to know that data now is always better than data delayed.

[01:57:10] I believe the new framework is clear, I think it is transparent, and I think it differentiates appropriately. Having every student in one category, every school in one category tells you little to nothing. I believe the new system's clarity and differentiation will empower parents, teachers, principals, school boards, and you to know what's working and what's not. I also believe the new system has an accurate focus on growth, which I think needs to continue. As a former teacher and principal, I can tell you I was always proud to see my students progress, but you can't

[01:57:47] lose sight of proficiency which I also think the new majors do well. Lastly, I believe that this will provide the data that you need to know how to build up where we're working, to have other schools see what's working, but also to target your resource towards what's failing. And I can tell you as a former principal and school founder that there are five words I always hated to hear. I wish I had known. There were so often I'd have parents come into my school school, getting straight A's, their students getting straight A's at other schools which were highly rated, and they would come in and they would take our test, and I would tell them that their student was a year or two years behind.

[01:58:27] I can't tell you the frustration that the parents face and the dejection in their heart as they would say to me again, I wish I'd only known. Worse yet was a student that would come in and say, Mr. Max, I always was a straight A student. I wish someone had told me sooner that I didn't know X.

[01:58:45] And I can tell you that every year, every minute, every month matters. We can't delay on implementing these. I'm frustrated that there are school boards wanting to delay what is simply data that doesn't really have much of a penalty behind it, and if anything, we'll only encourage you guys to give added support where it's needed.

[01:59:06] Do not delay on the new accountability measures. These are the right thing to do, and it will empower parents, and it will empower you. Thank you. Is there anyone else present that wishes to speak that has not already spoken?

[01:59:23] I will close the public comment. And we are moving to our consent agenda. Is there a motion to waive first review and approve the items on the consent agenda?

[01:59:39] Okay, any discussion? Ms. Holton? Ms. Ashton? Ms. McPherson? Ms. Kilgore? Dr. Northern? Dr. Bryce? Mr. Rotherham? And Chair votes aye.

[01:59:57] okay moving on to item e this is the final review of the board annual report is there a motion to review for final review of the 2024 annual report on the condition and needs of public schools in virginia and delegate the authority for any final edits to the board president the superintendent is there any discussion here yes miss holton just briefly

[02:00:35] just I don't want to belabor the point I know we've got a lot on our agenda but I just want to indicate that I'm going to dissent on the annual report I have a number of issues and I won't go through all of them but I'll just highlight one I think that the report significantly downplays our issues with teacher shortages we have severe we are we're doing better this year than last year we're coming down off of the pandemic high but our teacher shortages are still three times what they were when we flagged them as a major issue in 2017 we had a thousand some vacancies in 2017 and thought that was a crisis we now have

[02:01:13] three thousand some they impact particularly our neediest schools serving our neediest students I saw a recent analysis that said 20% of the teachers in our neediest schools are either they are it's positions are either vacant or filled by provisional licensees I'm also concerned about the lack of attention to the provisional licensee crisis and its implications for student success and for those reasons and others I will dissent

[02:01:50] Ms. Holton? Ms. Ashton? Ms. McPherson? Ms. Kilgore? Aye. Dr. Northern? Dr. Brice? Mr. Rotherham? Aye.

[02:02:06] Chair votes aye. Item F, final review of K-12 career exploration definition. Is there a motion to approve the proposed definition of career exploration as presented in the attached documents? So moved. Second. Any discussion? Ms. Holton?

[02:02:25] Adam Creasy and I'm glad Dr. Armstrong's with us I'm confused the attachment to this item I don't think it's the right attachment it's not the attachment that was this this refers to being you look like you can straighten this out it looks like it refers to being final review of an item we referred in September and that was a different item and this item appears to be the definitional work we did yesterday for which we gave you significant feedback and you told us you were going to work with stakeholders to fix so yes help me help me I did note that the item that had been uploaded to SharePoint this morning was the work

[02:03:03] based learning definition that should be the career exploration definition I believe that was reloaded this morning but again apologies if that was I'm not seeing it yet so so what are I don't well maybe it is there that's what we need to be saying the the item and how does this if I may I'm sorry president Creasy how does this item distinguish from item G item G I get the career guidance academic and career plan guidelines and that refers to the proper item from that we previously reviewed but what are we doing in item

[02:03:39] F yes ma'am and first review in September we provided the board with a a document that included the career exploration definition and academic career plan guidelines for your consideration. We've taken that item and divided it into two separate items for you today.

[02:03:56] It is the same content, but it's just been divided into a career exploration definition and the academic career plan guidelines document. Okay, so what the correct attachment for item F is now, I am now seeing it, is the final draft of the definition of career exploration, but it's not the work-based learning definition that we discussed yesterday we'll be back with that in February and and the career exploration definition I haven't had an opportunity to read what's just been loaded but it is the same document that we saw in September it is and if I

[02:04:32] may madam president we did make some revisions based on significant feedback we received from the field that included the Virginia Middle School Association VAESP, VASSP, our lab school network, and also the feedback we received from the board.

[02:04:48] Ms. Holtan, you mentioned changing the full day requirement of job shadowing that you had noticed. We changed that to requiring or suggesting a job shadowing requirement. We received resources from Dr. Northern with some career exploration activities that were from other states and national resources.

[02:05:04] Ms. McPherson has given us contacts who have been part of the feedback loop as well, so we have made revisions accordingly. Madam President, may I just, I don't think, I'm sure it's fine, but since

none of us have seen it, unless you all caught up with it more this morning than I did, can I suggest that we delay this item until after a break so we can take a minute to look at it?

[02:05:25] Absolutely. Happy to do that. Dr. Northern? Yeah, I would just encourage us to try to meld our discussion yesterday with this one. So, you know, my comment on, okay, maybe the job shadowing and the mentoring can occur at a career exploration phase in middle school.

[02:05:48] And I think, you know, maybe incorporating some of that and hearkening back to the work-based definition we discussed yesterday. I'm just trying to get these things to hang together a little bit better instead of sort of seeming like, you know, disjointed. And that's our goal as well.

[02:06:04] And not to jump ahead, but in the next item when we talk about the academic career plan guidelines, You'll see a table of suggested activities, and we can integrate some of those job shadowing opportunities that we were talking about yesterday into those suggested activities and competencies for the academic career plan.

[02:06:21] Okay. It looks like they could be mentioned in the definition as well. Yes, ma'am. Is that right? Okay, so we'll hold on item F for the moment and circle back on that. Item G, academic career plan guidelines.

[02:06:40] that was uploaded properly and should to my knowledge yes ma'am is there a motion to approve the proposed revisions to the academic career plan as presented in the attached documents any discussion here just very briefly a question to dr.

[02:07:01] Armstrong this doesn't approving this item today doesn't foreclose any of the feedback addressing any of the feedback we addressed with you yesterday on the work-based learning. In other words, this can be approved independently. We don't need to hold this till February. Yes, ma'am. Any other comments? Ms.

[02:07:30] Holton? Aye. Ms. Ashton? Aye. Ms. McPherson? Aye. Ms. Kilgore? Aye. Dr. Northern? Aye. Dr. Bryce? Aye. Mr. Rotherham? Aye. Chair votes aye. Okay, item H, final review of proposed state-approved textbooks for 612 English. Is there a motion to approve the attached list proposed recommended textbooks for grade 612 English. Are there any questions or comments here? Dr. Northern. I mentioned

[02:08:05] this at our last meeting and I'd still love to see some options for full novels in terms of an option there. I still think we're missing quite a few high-quality instructional materials and texts that have got strong backing in other states and I realized that a lot of folks don't come to Virginia because we're not a big market it's not required or mandatory I mean there are all kinds of reasons why we're not getting a lot of interest from the publishers but I

[02:08:41] I would still suggest that we try to issue another round of inquiries and applications and that sort of thing, because I'd hate for us not to have all of these other providers on our list that other states have and that have shown in multiple studies to be quite effective.

[02:09:00] And I'd like to somehow try to continue to lure them here and try to get them to apply. - So Ms. Cooper, is there a means by which you have the ability or maybe even Dr. Coons just discuss I know Dr. Northern has raised the issue of novels before but that in my understanding is more of a local choice type of option that exists within the ELA standards that can be addressed locally is that the case or am I misunderstanding good morning I think there's a few things the first one is

[02:09:37] yes divisions have choice to choose whatever curriculum they want to for 6 to 12, this list provides them an option of already vetted materials to make sure they're aligned to the standards, to make sure they're aligned to instructional best practices, and really relieves the burden of them having to do this process on their own. They may choose to select a curriculum from this list or not. I think the other important thing to know is we review the materials that are submitted, and so if a curriculum company has novels in their curriculum, they would have been reviewed as part of their process and if they don't we review the tech sets or whatever is

[02:10:16] Submitted I think the third thing And to follow up on what you were saying dr. Northern from the feedback last time We have started a process where we will add those tech sets like you mentioned to our instructional guides So we're working with various stakeholders teachers across the Commonwealth in addition to higher ed to put tech sets together as examples in the instructional guides which are the resources that teachers use alongside of the standards to plan for their instruction I just want to clarify those are long novel based text exemplars so there'll be an exemplar list not

[02:10:55] necessarily an analogy or anthology of short text but full-scale lists dr. Bryce you recommended that we speak with someone she is part of that committee that is working on that exemplar list to signal just as this instructional material signals to the field high-quality full-text novels that meet the curriculum are the standards requirements any other questions or comments here dr. northern I'll just clarify that text sets are different

[02:11:31] than having English textbooks recommended for approval I totally get tech sets i think they're a great idea they show how you can increase um you know content knowledge and background knowledge um i'll just lay my cards out on the table honestly odell reading reconsidered fish tank el education wit wisdom i'd love to see all of those on this list for whatever reason i'm sure there are many valid reasons they're not on here i'm simply just advocating for us to you know potentially have another opportunity for additional textbook

[02:12:07] companies and publishers to apply and no way want to hold up what we've got here already on this list I would second that and thought and recognize that may not affect our vote today but if the sorry sorry if the department could respond to whether that's a possibility we'd love to hear miss Cooper did any of those publishers that dr. norther mentioned apply in the first round and we under state law are not able to reach out to particular publishers and encourage them

[02:12:45] to apply is that correct correct that would be inappropriate for us to do during that process if a school division wanted to use a textbook that was not on the list is the process that they would still have to submit the proposed one to to you as a part of like this plan and i guess similar to what ronald city brought up this morning or could they just go outside the guideline because i'm noticing in the in the explanation

[02:13:23] that we have for item h it does say that you can use other textbooks but is it really really clear what the process is or do we need to clarify the process so that divisions feel the flexibility which would address, you know, the concern about board members here.

[02:13:43] Sure. So if they choose to not use a textbook on our approved list, they still have to go through a review process. So one of the benefits and probably the main benefit of using the list we have is that they don't have to do that vetting process, which takes a very long time, a lot of manpower and a lot of expertise, but they definitely have to do a review process on their own.

[02:14:04] They do not have to include their six through 12 core instruction in the division literacy plan that part is not required by law it's only the k-5 core curriculum that has to be included in the division literacy plan any other comments or questions here i do want to clarify that the k-5 list governed by the virginia literacy act is different than what um miss cooper just said it is required to use off of that list just for the general public but

[02:14:37] the 612 list does have the options that Miss Cooper mentioned okay other comments or questions dr. northern I'm just trying to clarify relative to the public comment we received earlier the implications of a district several large districts using a curriculum that's been approved by other entities quite vigorously and what and what that would mean for them you're saying that let's say they had a curriculum that was K through 8 right if they were using it

[02:15:16] for those middle school grades and the ELA and the k5 grades then they would have to then go through the approval process just for k5 but not 6/8 am I right about that no the UVA does the process for k5 materials and that list has been approved you all have approved that before if they choose to use a a textbook for six eight that is not on our list they would have to complete a review process and that review process is through I'm sorry it's through the division it's through the division they would do that on their own if they choose to not use an approved curriculum from our list that went through our

[02:15:54] state process okay I guess my last comment would just be to clarify some of these sort of because when I look at this sometimes you see recommended for approval and you just don't realize okay you know these are some other options that are available to me if we don't use this and this is a process if we've got a you know a material not on here I just complete I'm just worried that the divisions are going to get confused between what's required and what's recommended and the process is for both that they don't have to go through the DOE they don't have to go through UVA you know that it's up to

[02:16:31] their division to approve that I would be happy to clarify and communicate that better that was my my concern is it a way that when you roll this out you can also roll out what the distinction is between the k5 required material and the process and then the six through well I guess it would be because I think that's really really really important at this point especially since we're trying to make sure that we give more guidance that maybe has been done in the past

[02:17:02] questions or comments on this item before we move on okay so there is a motion that's been made and seconded to approve the list attached of the proposed recommended textbooks for 612 English miss Hulton I miss Ashton hi miss McPherson miss Kilgore dr. Northern dr. Bryce mr. Rotherham and chair votes I

[02:17:37] okay item I miss Berta thank you good morning president Creasy members of the board dr. Coons before you under this item is a request first and final review and reallocation of SCAP schools construction assistance program funding from the fiscal year 24 allocations that were made during your April meeting subsequent to that we have received word from two school divisions that they needed to shift their scope downward which then alters their original award

[02:18:16] from the state those school divisions being Patrick County and Lynchburg City Patrick County reduced their project scope cost from two million dollars originally to a million dollars which reduces their award amount from six hundred thousand to three hundred thousand Lynchburg City reduced their scope of work from a fifteen million dollar project to five million eight hundred and eighty five thousand two hundred and fifty dollars thus resulting in a decrease of their award from the state of four and a half

million to one million seven sixty five five seventy five this allows for reallocation of the unused grant funds and the amount of three million thirty four thousand four

[02:18:55] hundred and twenty five dollars within your executive summary there is a recommendation from us from staff on how we could redistribute those funds so during the award process in April Richmond City alternative school project did not receive fully full funding for their project they were a prorated amount due to the available funds at the time. So they originally received $374,979. The additional amount of their project is $1,009,021. Thus, we're making the recommendation that this project be fully funded with the redistributed money. In addition to that, there were two additional

[02:19:35] school projects that fell below the line of available funds, one being Smith County with Marion High School, where the project for the entire eligible grant amount is $1,155,000, and this project scored 77 points. The last project is to partially award $870,404 to Pennsylvania County Union Hall Elementary School, and this project scored 72 points.

[02:20:05] I'm happy to entertain any questions. The recommendation of the superintendent is for approval of this reallocation of funding okay is there a motion to wave first review and approve the proposed reallocation of available funds in the SCAP FY 24 any discussion or questions here mr. Rotherham previously we've done these on first and final over two meetings is there any reason like

[02:20:41] process-wise doing it first and final today that we should be aware of I think We want to make sure that these school divisions know that they have these awards available to them so that they can complete their project, particularly the Richmond City project.

[02:20:57] And their mid-project. And their end process, yes. Any other questions? Dr. Koenster, do you want to say anything? Ms. McPherson, do you have a comment? Yeah. So when would you plan to bring it back to us in February for a final review?

[02:21:15] No, now. No, ma'am. We're requesting approval today so that we can notify those three school divisions. All right. That makes sense. other comments or questions miss Holton I miss Ashton hi miss McPherson miss Kilgore dr. Northern dr. Bryce mr. Rotherham and chair votes aye okay and miss birdie you have the next one too yes ma'am thank you thank you president Creasy this one might take me a little bit longer to get through this is first

[02:21:54] review of proposed revisions to the guidelines that were previously approved for 2024 to 2026. This is a result of the General Assembly 2024 session House Bill 462 and Senate Bill 474 being passed to incorporate regional career technical center programs as eligible for the school construction assistance program grant awards. This change became effective July 1st. The legislative intent is to provide school major construction renovation and addition projects giving priority

[02:22:27] to high high needs school divisions regional cte programs and localities the funding is intended for those planned projects or those that are placed planned that lack sufficient funding from the locality and are not yet in the construction phase program funding is awarded through a competitive criteria through an application-based process this competitive criteria must reflect categories of commitment need and poor school building conditions and have a minimum qualifying criteria score established for a project to qualify for funding department staff have updated

[02:23:04] the data using several selection criteria so that the latest data is available in the upcoming application processes it maintains a minimum criteria score of 65 points on a 100 point scale that was

previously adopted by the board as a minimum qualifying score for a project to be funded under these guidelines school division and regional cte programs apply to vdoe for grant funding on during designated open application periods the awards are funded based on 10 20 or

[02:23:38] 30 percent of the approved project cost depending on the division's composite index and local fiscal stress category as determined by the report on comparative revenue capacity revenue effort and fiscal stress of virginia counties and cities as published by the virginia commission on local government the proposed guidelines for the 2426 biennium are shown in attachment one of your agenda with the key changes being the following includes the addition of regional cte programs pursuant to house bill 462 and senate bill 474 from the 24 general assembly session as being eligible for

[02:24:18] grant awards given the level of funding for the program and to enable more school division and regional cte programs which have alignment with the virginia office of econ education economics or voe high demand occupation list and evidence of analysis with regional workforce and higher education strategies to receive funding school divisions and regional cte programs may only apply for one school project during the open application period we have added a selection criteria to the award a maximum of two points for a regional cte program that provides open

[02:24:57] enrollment to students and will accept students who do not have access to this type of programming in their region in addition it provides funding for cte programs that have support from industry or post-secondary support could include letters from their local employers that they have partnerships with letters of support from geo virginia board and other other support mechanisms we have added a 13 13 selection criteria to the guidelines in which school divisions or regional cte programs that did not receive grant awards in the previous two years will receive an additional

[02:25:34] five points as part of the scoring process one important note is with the addition of the cte regional programs if any school division that is part of that regional program received a grant award they are not penalized so in round one all cte regional programs that apply will be awarded the five points so no nobody will be penalized if their school division received an award the The identified student percentage used as part of the community eligibility program for our school nutrition services replaces the free and reduced lunch eligibility data.

[02:26:10] We are finding that that free and reduced lunch eligibility data is becoming less and less relevant with the migration to CEP and ISP becomes the more updated and standardized measure in this area for student poverty. We have adjusted the percentage range awarding points for percentages of residents of the local locality and a school division located with incomes at or below the federal poverty level and this is based on the US Census Bureau safety December 23 data which is the small area income and poverty estimates program we have adjusted the percentage ranges for the award points for debt capacity and

[02:26:49] localities to enable some divisions that were short of qualifying points to potentially qualify for future funding we have also made clarifications that That major changes in scope and project cost after grant awards are issued or transfer to another school project may result in the project's grant funding being forfeited and the funds awarded to the next eligible school or regional CTE center project application.

[02:27:17] We have added a requirement for selected grant recipients to report on the status of funded projects including funding sources for overall projects including the SCAP funds, the percentage of the

SCAP allocation that is used and the status of the overall project being project complete.

[02:27:36] Also, we want to know from them when they anticipate their project to be completed. We will coordinate this collection to lessen the burden on localities in coordination with a existing data collection that we already collect from them annually. Several of these changes are in response to comments and requests that we have received from school divisions and local governments.

[02:27:58] attachment to provides the criteria that are reflective of the changes that I have just discussed so this is certainly for first review and we'll bring this back to you in February but I am happy to answer any questions you may have are there any questions thank you for this thorough presentation and I applaud the changes from the legislature and from the department implementing those to uh include the cte centers that's a great addition and boosting their applications makes perfect

[02:28:34] sense the changes to the economic disadvantage criteria make perfect sense my questions go to the uh two limitations the the one where divisions will only will be limited to only one project per round tell me what what is it what is around so an application process so when we open the application a school division will only be able to submit for one project and a CTE Regional Center would only be able to submit for one project that will

[02:29:11] allow us to distribute the funds more broadly across the Commonwealth certainly if we have additional funds it is only an 80 million dollar round this time so it's not as substantial of an investment that has been made in past rounds so we're trying to stretch those funds further to impact more school divisions so for instance what we just did making an adjustment that was part of the last round that's for it's basically one round per general assembly a lot basically one round at most one round a year that's the goal yes and certainly if we have additional funds we could do more so there are two provisions you're proposing and I just I realized we're not being asked to vote

[02:29:49] on them today but I want to hear your thoughts on and invite the public to in have input on that would it that I'm concerned would unduly harm students in large school divisions or even mid side school divisions over some of our very small school divisions so one in particular I think I'm hearing you say a proposed new criteria would say that only a school division can only submit one application that means one school one project per round we have school divisions as you know that have a hundred and ninety-nine schools you know we have one division anyway that has a hundred and ninety-nine schools in a

[02:30:28] division we have a number that are almost as large and then we have divisions that have two schools in a division so the school the students in those larger divisions are you know two hundred times disproportionately X able to access this funding compared to the divisions with only two schools in In addition, I'm hearing that there is now a plus five, which is not small, plus five points criteria for folks who haven't won an award in a prior year.

[02:31:04] Got 131 divisions, many of them quite small. That basically means that you're gonna have your larger divisions put behind the very tiny divisions for otherwise needy projects by the five point boost, which is again not a significant not a small number of points in this allocation system are you concerned at all about that I mean yes we want the the funds to be spread geographically and demographically in all kinds of ways but I'm concerned about the overweighting of our very small divisions

[02:31:44] relative to our larger divisions we are certainly open to any feedback that the board has in this relation I think part of the strategy was knowing that we went from 400 million dollars to 80 million dollars

and trying to maximize the distribution of that was part of the thought process behind why we made that a criteria piece to try to share the share the love with other school divisions that have not been the benefactor of previous awards if I may follow one more follow-up miss Holton are there other criteria that emphasize region I feel

[02:32:19] like we've had some discussion in the past about regional diversity are there other criteria that help capture regional diversity or there are other ways of going about addressing the need to spread the resources out without treating the division with two schools in the division with 199 schools I think the same I think the addition of the CTE programming the regional CTE centers helps address part of that and that has been a focus of the work-based learning and all of the components to educate students so I think the addition of the

[02:32:56] CTE is phase one of how we are regionally incorporating funding distributions to regional so that it maximizes a number of school divisions that participate in that programming yes perhaps with the funding pot being as limited as it is a relative cup to prior rounds this time is it potentially the case that basically all the funds this time are going to go to the regional CTE programs and so that the rest of the ranking is almost irrelevant or is that not so it's hard for me to say that without under understanding what the

[02:33:34] application process will lend itself to certainly we can look at that as the application process opens but it would be it would be premature for me to even state that without knowing the application process so so thank you so I I just want to say I don't mean to disparage the needs of our smaller divisions understand they can be very important but I think there are a lot of the other criteria that would help them their applications be boosted and I worry about this criteria and invite the public's guidance and help to us and invite the board to think about that as we come to final next month next meeting

[02:34:09] certainly any other comments here thank you thank you accept this for first review and see you next month okay I I'll give you guys the option here here we can take a quick five-minute break come back and then do lunch in about an hour that's okay yeah all right five-minute break thank you

[02:34:38] Lomas in Virginia Public Schools is there a motion to waive first review and

[02:47:22] approve the Board of Education approved courses to satisfy graduation requirements for the standard advanced studies and modified standard diplomas in Virginia public schools second any discussion on this item miss Holton I miss Ashton I miss McPherson miss Kilgore dr. Northern I dr. Bryce mr.

[02:47:47] Rotherham and chair votes on okay item L first and final review of fast-track regulatory action to amend 8 vac 20 - 23 to align with the Virginia Literacy act is there a motion to waive first review and approve the regulatory change included in this item as recommended by abtel um mr gilstraff do you have a presentation for us i just have information if you'd like it we had i did this presentation in october for chapter 543 and in that meeting i mentioned i'd be back with chapter 23 the changes are very minimal uh no nothing

[02:48:26] different than what we made in the chapter 543 earlier thank you so is there a motion to waive first review and approve the regulatory change included with this item recommended by ABTEP so moved second any questions or comments on this item discussion madam president I know this is not directly

related but while we're on a literacy act item I'd just like to follow up on the comment we heard public comment from dr. Siebert this morning a passionate plea for the

[02:49:02] wit and wisdom program and other program that Roanoke City is using with wisdom and really great reading we did approve an appeals process a year ago and it's my understanding that they have been pursuing that appeals opportunity ever since so that dr. Coons I'm I don't know whether you're prepared to address it today but if not today perhaps before our February meeting we could hear an update on where we are I think the spirit of our the assurances you gave us a year ago is that you you had the authority to take care of this and help

[02:49:37] us on it I don't have an appeals process we brought that to the board it was not approved so I have an appeals but the process has not been approved did we turn it down at some point I thought we approved it a year ago on December and that's certainly the what Dr. Siebert referenced the item that was on in December of 2023 so it was the the idea of a process to actually have an appeal is what we did then there is no actual process that's been established

[02:50:13] so what's happening so again this may not be the right time to do this but we need some counsel to help us with that and I'm not sure that council is prepared with that so recognizing none of us may be ready to address it but I thought the clear decision we made in December of 2023 was to authorize the the superintendent to adopt a clear process and then process those appeals the language was we approved the core instructional program and directed the superintendent to create an appeals process by which local school diversions

[02:50:50] currently using curriculum they be said to come to the superintendent and the for that approval so that was over a year ago and I'm just distressed that we haven't made any progress on it and would love to have the superintendent's guidance at the appropriate time I mean you know these millions of dollars and children's success are on the line and you know it's been a year okay so we will be bringing this issue back in February there needs to be clear guidance from council on this so we're asking the department to consult with council and and bring us something to act on in February?

[02:51:24] - That's correct. - Thank you. - Madam President. - Yes. - So I'm disappointed I won't be here in February, that's really important. I think we, an appeals process is fine. I just, since I'm not gonna be here, I wanna just take a moment to say, I think we need to be very careful because not having a literacy act and having science of reading aligned instruction is a problem.

[02:51:47] What is also a problem, in some ways a worse problem, is if you start to have science of reading, appearance that everything is science of reading aligned I'm not passing judgment on any of the things we've heard of this in general as a matter of policy but in fact you have a review process that's not robust and so you then have the illusion that you're doing science of reading when in fact you're not is in some ways worse than just saying we're not science of reading aligned and we need to get that it's confusing it's not transparent so I just urge us to make sure that the process is really robust any any process we come up with anchored

[02:52:24] that and that we really you know the both the intent and the importance of where we're going on science of reading and the literacy act and all the work behind that is tremendously important we want to make sure we don't start the process of slowly moving moving away from that I do agree completely with your comments I just want to be very clear that we are gonna need to seek our counsel on this to have

any kind of action moving forward so that being said is there any are there any other comments on this item before we vote

[02:53:03] miss Holton aye miss Ashton aye miss McPherson miss Kilgore Dr. Northern aye dr. Bryce mr. Rotherham and chair votes aye thank you very much and you have the next item as well item M first and final review of the advisory board on board on teacher education and licensure's recommended recommendation to approve new a new education endorsement program or programs do you have anything to prep us for this one I do I have one thing I want to make sure

[02:53:39] everyone's aware first this is great news adding 24 programs is a great step for us over the past couple years most of our universities have pushed pause on adding new programs. The one that's adding the most on this one shut down several of their programs and now are bringing them back. I think it is an encouragement that there are people interested in being teachers. You don't add programs if you don't have people interested in doing those programs, so it is definitely a positive. I also wanted to point out that in the original submission, University of Lynchburg's special education deaf and hard hearing

[02:54:16] program was listed as undergraduate. It is a graduate program and it has been updated but if you have old documents you might not notice that i just want for their sake to be clear that that program is a graduate program should you choose to approve them the attachment does designate that it is a graduate okay are there is there a motion to waive first review and accept abtel's recommendation to approve these new education endorsement are there any questions or discussion on this item i'm hearing none miss holton

[02:54:54] Ms. Ashton? Aye. Ms. McPherson? Aye. Ms. Kilgore? Aye. Dr. Northern? Aye. Dr. Brice? Aye. Mr. Rotherham? Aye. And chair votes aye. Thank you. Okay. Item N. First and final review of regulatory changes to align with the Office of Children's Services regulatory revisions. Mr. Chapman, would you like to preface our action on this, please?

[02:55:21] Thank you, President Kreese. So very quickly, this is a fast-track action, which means that the board is, in theory, exercising a very minimal amount of discretion. These changes are expected to be non-controversial under state law and the regulatory process. Essentially, what happened is that on March 14, 2024, the State Executive Council for Children's Services approved revisions to its Policy 4.2, Payment for Services and Change of Legal Residence, which were then implemented on July 1 of this year.

[02:55:49] Along with those changes, they require just some technical updates to the board's chapter regarding special education, Chapter 81. This basically consists of a couple of very minor changes, adding a few definitions in order to clarify the policy and then amending one section.

[02:56:08] There's a couple of other technical changes that take place in this. The code in Chapter 81 still referred to the Comprehensive Services Act instead of the Children's Services Act, so we've updated that as well. so is there a motion to waive first review and approve the action as presented and delegate to bdoe staff authority to make any additional changes as necessary to comply with the policy update second are there any questions or is there discussion on this item okay miss holton

[02:56:48] miss ashton aye miss mcpherson miss kilgore dr northern aye dr bryce aye mr rotherham and chair votes aye okay and mr. Chapman item oh first and final review of the finalization of periodic reviews of regulations as the board remembers we have been doing this pretty regularly mr. Chapman would you like to preface this action thank you present crazy yes process wise where the board is in this as we have

opened periodic reviews pursuant to the board's direction in January of this year on a few or sorry now June of this year on these chapters and so we're not ready

[02:57:25] to close out the periodic review process essentially these chapters have already been out for public comment. Staff has analyzed them, has chatted with the Office of the Attorney General. And we do have a couple of chapters that we believe, you know, need some action in terms of closing out these periodic reviews. We are recommending some modest changes on a couple of chapters, some reductions, continuing to pursue the strategy of taking any regulatory chapter that's a small chapter that's directed at school divisions and moving these into our chapter of regulations governing local school boards and school divisions just for ease of use.

[02:58:02] I will note that in terms of Chapter 40, which is the regulations governing educational services and gifted students, staff also recommends that along with retaining this chapter as is for the moment, the board does have an action that has been out on this chapter for a considerable period of time. We recommend going ahead and withdrawing that action until the board's new VACAL, the Virginia Advanced Learning Committee that has recently been set up has time to look at that chapter independently under the board's direction.

[02:58:34] This chapter, this action has been going on since, I think, 2019, and there's been no action to it since April of 2021. So we think that that action should be withdrawn in order for VACAL to take a more serious look at that. We will be bringing back to you some of these regulatory changes for the other chapters.

[02:58:52] Chapter 70, Regulations Governing People, Transportation. We think that there's a couple of minor updates that need to be done in order to align with code and simplify some language. The literary loan chapter, we believe, is actually those directions are exempt under state law, and so we will be bringing in action to repeal that entire chapter because it pertains to grants of state funds.

[02:59:14] We actually don't need regulations. We think this will be a really big asset to the department since there's almost always budget language regarding literary loans, And that fund will allow staff to be more nimble in bringing something to the board to reflect changes and then going ahead and continuing to implement those as is.

[02:59:31] The regulations governing career and technical education and regulations governing jointly owned and operated schools and jointly operated programs, staff believes those should be retained as is as well. Excuse me. Is there a motion to waive first review and approve closing the periodic reviews on the regulatory chapters identified in this item as presented to the board and to additionally withdraw action 5325 periodic review of the regulations governing education services for gifted students which has not been acted upon

[03:00:05] since April 2021 so are there any questions or is there a discussion on this item hearing none miss Holton miss Ashton hi miss McPherson miss Kilgore aye Dr. Northern aye Dr. Bryce aye Mr. Rotherham aye and chair votes aye thank you item p first review of regulatory actions resulting from periodic reviews thank you and I will clarify

[03:00:39] this item is for first review so we will bring this back in February of this year all of these are actions resulting from periodic reviews that the board has closed within the last few months we don't expect that any of these changes will be particularly controversial a lot of these will be you know very brief

amendments to the regulations in one case there's a chapter the regulations governing general education development certificates that staff had discovered in the periodic review that this chapter just simply run its course and so doesn't know no longer needs to be an active regulatory chapter and then a couple of these again we will be consolidating under our regulations governing local school boards and school

[03:01:18] divisions for mr. Chapman on this okay hearing none thank you we will accept this item for first review and see you in February okay item Q is mr. gilstrap first and final review of allocation of funding for national board certified classroom teachers this is this came out of our discussion yesterday go ahead mr.

[03:01:48] gilstrap I'm gonna go ahead and read some of this just because it wasn't on our original agenda so I just wanted to be clear in the records purpose for this presentation at our work session yesterday the board indicated a desire to provide funding pursuant of current FY 2025 budget language in different phases and move forward with the first round of payments immediately in the conversation at the work session the board determined that the first phase of distribution would be to provide bonuses from state funds to cap classroom teachers in Virginia Public Schools who hold certification certification from the National Board professional teaching standards such bonuses shall be

[03:02:28] 5,000 the first year of certification and 2,500 annually thereafter for the life of the certificate the board also requested that the staff provide a recommendation at their February meeting for the district distribution of funds to other public schools staff members and qualified individuals specific schools as outlined in the FY 2025 budget language I do want to point out that one of the questions or comments that we had yesterday in our discussion I was able to find a little bit more information on so this is on the action

[03:03:04] requested part if you want to read along with me the FY 2025 budget language from the 2024 General Assembly session takes priority over the code of Virginia citations what this means is the 4,997,500 that the budgetary language speaks of is the only money available for this fund so once we have done the classroom teachers we will be able to come back with you and say this is how much money is remaining and get your guidance on how you'd like to go forward with that so I do believe you had that miss Holton had suggested that

[03:03:41] not only do we so the motion should actually say and correct me if I'm wrong that initially our priority is those classroom teachers that currently hold that certification and those classroom teachers second second the second tier then would be those classroom teachers who are currently in the process of seeking the candidates yes that's right so I just want to make sure that that's clear in this motion that we are we want those two and that's correct your statement is correct but I don't think the motion is correct it does not

[03:04:17] include that second tier that's yeah so there's also another group that we would want to mention if we were going to include them all because we would also want to include all of the current national board license holders that are not in classrooms that would include the principals counselors and central administration staff in what order would we do that and I believe that is the second part that we're going to come back to in February so this motion should contain currently certified classroom teachers and those who are

[03:04:53] currently working towards that certification so that's all that was part of that discussion for our the immediacy of that that distribution of funds and then in February we would come back and discuss

those additional opportunities once we know how much has been distributed out of the fund based on this those people if that's the will the board absolutely yeah and can I add one thing before i just want to point out that that second group the candidates will take a

[03:05:27] little bit more time to delineate because that is a different process not that we can't do that within the time frame before february but it'll be closer to that february board meeting for that group to be fully identified and to know how much money comes out of that group that's the only reason that would have been left off because that group will just take more time okay and it and i think it's clear that we mean the first group that you've put in the motion is our first priority and if funds remain to then go to the applicant group and then if funds remain beyond that we can consider how to prioritize them at our February meeting so I think we do need some language to do that if that's the

[03:06:07] will of the board the other thing I wanted to address I think I'm hearing you say that you don't think we have beyond we don't have any surplus funds from prior years that we can expend I know that we don't well so I don't I'd love to have more clarity on that when we come back together in February I don't need to push for it today because I don't think that's relevant to today's motion but unless the budget language specifically takes back the non reverting money I concur with your analysis that budget language overrides statutory language but only if they differ so if the statutory language says there's a

[03:06:47] non reverting fund and the appropriations language doesn't address it one way or the other then I think we still have that non reverting fund and so would hope that you all can clarify that for us when we come back in February so I actually discussed this yesterday with the Department of Budget and Planning to make sure I had a clear understanding and that non reverting fund was established through the statutory code language in 1999 it was never been any funding applied to that and so appropriation language trumps that virginia

[03:07:21] state code section and the appropriation language does not speak to any excess balances going to their the non-reverting fund there is opportunity for us to submit a request to the money committee staff to amend the language in the appropriation act to allow for any excess dollars to be carried over into the non reverting fund but that would take initiative from us to the money committees to ask for that language change so if I may just so

[03:07:52] there never has been any money put into a non reverting fund that is yes miss dr. Bryce in the first round we're including classroom teachers people working towards the certification but prioritizing classroom teachers working towards the certification or is it everybody working towards this no I let let me let me let me ask let me ask miss Holton it might be easier given the data

[03:08:25] need on those aspiring to certify if we simply use what is currently drafted as the motion for this month and defer I'm comfortable with that he tells us it's gonna take almost that long to get the money out the door anyway I just think is worth our clarifying that it is our intent that that be the next round and that we direct the department to bring that motion back to us for consideration in February just so the legislature knows we're not ignoring the changes they made last year okay so if no one has issues with the way you know we've

[03:09:03] just discussed this leaving this motion the way that it is I will reiterate it and we'll go deal with the other the second part for these um in february uh mr rotherham madame president i have a comment a question just the comment i'm i'm fine with proceeding this way i just want to note again like these dollars are not targeted to any kind of high need shortages anything like that many states do that i think

that's something we should consider um uh this is a very inefficient way to do this and it's misaligned with much of the other stuff we we talk about in terms of shortages in specific subjects geographies and so

[03:09:43] forth my question is such as the I don't want to be a broken record but that's a that's a comment because I think this is an important issue my question is we're comfortable that we have the data tracking on all this like that we had which is that I think the reason why we want to put some some part of this off until February because of the the lack of data that is concrete at this point okay that was a question for for Dr. Kuhn it's just yeah just to make sure that we're moving forward with we have data to track what's going on so

[03:10:20] just to mr. Rotherham I understand your motivation and but I don't think the statute gives us authority to do what you're asking us to do with respect to the bonus awards for holders of the certification maybe and we could ask the department but but I think it would only be if the statute gives us the authority to allocate if the funding isn't sufficient we can decide who to cut but we can't go as long as the funding is sufficient then we can't change the eligibility for the 5,000 and 2,500 the new provision for candidates

[03:11:00] is directed to high-need schools so in other words all I think you have a wise idea maybe somebody in the legislature will take it up Dr. Northern I'm just trying to clarify what we mean by candidates in the process of so we've got candidates who are applying new that have never applied before and then we've got candidates who are reapplying who are trying every five years or 10 or whatever it is to get that certification again so who are we talking about in the second group in February when we come back I get get that we're kind of punting this but can you clarify that second group of candidates so to speak

[03:11:38] absolutely it refers to title one teachers in title one schools that would be going toward that that goal so that's what and was that dr. Holton was talking about okay just follow up does that mean that they are getting compensated for the cost of applying yes that's not the full stipend it's just whatever they're paying to apply and it's only half up front and half at the end it's half apart and then if they don't make it then obviously that's just sunk cost correct we just paid for them to try do you remember yesterday there was a chart that indicated the application fees and those things so

[03:12:16] that's what we're they get half at the beginning and then they get the second half only if they're successful okay so what that means is that the original motion sorry to make everybody confused here is is as follows the motion would be to waive first review and approve the request to fund existing National certification teacher incentive award with the available 4.9975 million in budgeted funds to distribute five thousand for first year of the

[03:12:53] certificate holding and 2,500 for certificate holders after the first year to classroom teachers in Virginia public schools who hold certification from the National Board of Professional Teaching Standards so would anyone like to make

[03:13:12] that motion. So moved. Any comments or questions on this motion? Hearing none, Ms. Holton? Aye. Ms. Ashton? Aye. Ms. McPherson? Aye. Ms. Kilvore? Aye. Dr. Northern? Aye. Dr. Bryce? Aye. Mr. Rotherham? Aye. And chair votes aye. Thank you. Thank you. We need to return to item F. Do you have sufficient, have you had sufficient time to read that or would you like to have lunch and come back? I've read it. I have one brief

[03:13:50] question I've been speed reading man so thank you Dr. Armstrong for getting us the the on pay on the right page this document is labeled definition of career exploration but it really goes beyond definition to some specification of what is expected at k-5 grade 6 to 8 etc I just want to understand how binding is this you know this says all students for instance in grades 6 to 8 all students

[03:14:27] should do a B C and D one of those is complete at one at least one concrete job shadowing experience in a career cluster of interest that is just an example that to me sounds like a great idea but if Pennsylvania County for instance who spoke this morning they reminded me of the chance I got to sit on a bulldozer they do an incredible career fair every year which might well be a very concrete alternative to a job shadowing experience does this leave them in other words this should is how this is beyond a definition it's a

[03:15:04] description of what school divisions in each grade banner expected to do but is this more guidelines or is this a mandatory requirement must they do a document they've done a job shadow for each student in middle school or can they substitute alternatives for example thank you for that question and neither the definition of career exploration or the academic career plan guidelines include any mandatory requirements around what should be done. I do realize that the definition is fairly rigorous in how we took this and divided it out among elementary, middle, and high levels with suggested activities. So the operative word being "should." We know sensibly as an agency of course that

[03:15:44] different divisions may embark on activities that are closely related like you mentioned in Pennsylvania but may not exactly fit that description and that's something that will obviously support our school divisions as we work through this so should is not must thank you any other questions on item 8 I mean excuse me item F not H item F okay so given that is there a motion to approve the proposed definition of career exploration as presented in the documents attached to item F second any other questions or comments on this item

[03:16:21] before we go okay miss Holton hi miss Ashton hi miss McPherson miss Kilgore ah dr. Northern hi dr. Bryce hi mr. Rotherham hi and chair votes aye okay so that takes us to accepting written reports and presentations and discussion of current issues by board members I will call on board members as needed and

[03:16:57] then dr. Coons will wrap us up before we adjourn any other any board members have a comment before we adjourn thank you madam president I want to express my concern about items not on the agenda in particular as you know I have asked that we address today the I've been asking for many months in many board meetings that we address the item of how we go about setting the pass rates the cut score that determines the difference between a pass and a fail on our SOL

[03:17:33] test for this spring administration and I my request has been denied I've been told that we're going to take it up in February but I would like to suggest to the board and to the public that we're abdicating on our responsibility frankly because by February it will be too late to do anything other than accept the department's recommendation the department is the superintendent has told us I'm not sure whether it's been publicly shared or not but that the department is now recommending that we just use last year's cut scores even though the standards have been rewritten and the this is for all of math and all

[03:18:13] of literacy the standards have been rewritten the tests have been adjusted to accommodate the new content and yet we're going to use the cut scores from last year without the normal accommodation process that it's my understanding that teachers were recruited to serve on the standard setting

committees those committees were all ready to meet and they were canceled at the last minute this this within the last couple of weeks all of that without adequate explanation to us and it may well be that the right thing

[03:18:47] to do given the expedited implementation of these standards and the fact that we didn't get started on this standard setting process sooner it might well be that the right thing to do is to use last year's numbers but to me that's a board responsibility it's also a board responsibility to determine the process for setting standards and you know we heard a presentation back in July about some of the different methods the modified angle off method that we have used in the past but there were we heard about alternative ways to go about

[03:19:23] setting standards but that matter has not been brought to this board to address and I think that's a mistake it's not fair to the divisions to not let them know what we're doing and it's not appropriate for the board to abdicate to the department by by absence so to speak and it matters to students who are going to be trying to pass these tests this spring to know teachers and students to know what's the difference between passing and failing and and I I want to raise up for public concern the the fact that we have have

[03:20:00] not addressed that issue also not on the agenda today are just worth highlighting that the math textbooks approvals are not on the agenda today as we had expected them to be I understand they've been postponed because we don't have enough math textbooks but following up on dr.

[03:20:21] Northern's concerned about we don't have enough options on the English language the math as you remember we had only one option approved in the original round and so I think it's appropriate that we've continued the matter to try to see if we can get others in the door but it's just one more example of matters that I don't think we're adequately tending to the public business frankly because we've just taken on too much to be able to competently do everything we are required to do two other items we've we've heard about in the last couple of days the department has not fulfilled its responsibility to report to the

[03:20:56] General Assembly by July by November 1st on the RFI process for redoing our testing contract and we heard yesterday that it's with the Attorney General but the General Assembly didn't tell the Attorney General to report they told the department to report that's over a month overdue we also discussed yesterday the seat time requirements this board was supposed to have adopted new guidelines on seat time requirements by December 1st it wasn't that topic was not brought to our attention until a work session yesterday this is to me consistent with

[03:21:32] the overall pattern of this frankly the administration taken on too much and not being able to competently follow through on everything they've bit on that was one of the issues of the framework that the framework changes should have been adopted well before the school year started so people would be able to respond to those changes and I won't repeat the comments I made on those that subject topic yesterday but I'll just end with one final this this board has been very clear and this administration has been very clear for well since the very beginning of the administration and we're now at the end of year three that

[03:22:10] the board wanted to address what some people characterize as the honesty gap on our test scores I don't call it an honesty gap and don't necessarily agree that we need to make drastic changes we there may be some changes we need to address but that's been something this board has been talking about for three years and is now effectively by not acting today effectively deciding to punt that for yet

another school year such that whatever action this board takes and it may well be long after I'm gone but whatever actions this board

[03:22:45] takes to address what many of you characterize as the honesty gap won't take effect until the next administration. So four years from when this administration first started talking about it and when some other administration will be left to clean up whatever the implications are of drastic changes to the standard setting process. So I just raise up the concern that we're taking on too much to do everything to do fulfill our responsibilities well and encourage the board as we move forward to try to

[03:23:20] prioritize the most important items that we all are have consensus on like implementing the Literacy Act successfully thank you I'll just say that I feel like we have prioritized what's most important for the Commonwealth Children which is the you know support performance and framework SPSF as I call it but whatever we want to call it and the fact and as I said

[03:23:59] yesterday the resources that have been put in place for multiple audiences the number of sessions that that Dave and his group have just attended to with all of these divisions and their questions and the urgency with which we've had to act as a board given our devastating loss post pandemic and on the nape which was just jaw-dropping the losses that our kids are experiencing so in contrast to my fellow board members thoughts and feelings I actually do think we prioritize the most important work for the kids in this Commonwealth and I'm

[03:24:38] proud of the work that we've done and no we've not been able to check off every single box but the the work that we've been doing daunting and I feel like all of us have worked very hard including all of our divisions teachers educators we've all locked arms and tried to march forward with just this this huge challenge in front of us but I feel like I'm grateful for the the work of this board grateful for the work of all the people educating kids and this

[03:25:12] Commonwealth and just want to wish everybody a happy holidays and Christmas thank you anyone else yes so we are where we are I guess I keep saying that a little bit but let me highlight that a little bit so it's been a massive of undertaking there's a huge system you know many school divisions all over this commonwealth and a lot of nuances and a lot of moving parts so now that we are where we are we would have

[03:25:48] anticipated ahead of time that there would be some problems i think your credit uh miss holton that technically the issue about the pass rate is one that gives me a concern because the school divisions do need to know but i think the border is committed and has been committed to doing whatever we can do to shorten the time frame so whether that means we meet in december whether we call a special meeting whether we have a work session if the staff believes that we need to do something before we have our meeting in february then i think all of us are committed to it that

[03:26:24] doesn't move the clock up a whole lot but to the extent that we can i think we're all committed to doing so i just wouldn't employ the staff why i want i want to thank them it's the end of the year for all the hard work that they have done over the course of the year because i don't think necessarily that we give them enough praise for what they have done so with that saying i'm just saying that this board is committed to the staff to say that if you need us in the interim and statutorily it can be done if you believe that there's some emergency issues we need to do that i've listened to the public with the different concerns that they have i still think we have

[03:27:03] some out there that need to be addressed they need to be addressed immediately and especially going forward in the new year to try to clean those up as much as we possibly can recognizing that the breadth of the people that have come before us it appears as if they have been in sync with what we're doing but we still have some issues that we need to treat because the public after all the other people that we serve and we need to make sure that we answer all of their questions however long it takes and how much time we have to dedicate to it by now we need to do what we need to do other comments miss ashton president creasy and board

[03:27:43] i i also want to echo just the appreciation for the staff and the team and for the board for doing some very heavy lifting and work i was just counting that i've officially been here for over a year and thinking about the work around standards and innovative schools and performance frameworks and now a whole toolkit for parents and families and teachers and state superintendents i think it's pretty remarkable around the collaboration the tough conversations and

[03:28:16] the thoughtfulness that has gone into this work to move virginia forward urgently and thoughtfully also want to echo yes there is still more work to be done and i along with other board members will roll up our sleeves to do it but i just want to thank the team and the staff and the board members for really doing some heavy heavy lifting over this it feels like 10 years for me just to be honest to all the work that we've done and i'm just excited for what comes ahead for all the students and families who we serve so thank you very briefly madam president I

[03:28:54] just want to I thank miss miss McPherson and miss Ashton for helping me remember that I too want to commend the staff and nothing I said cast any aspersions on the incredible hard work the staff has done to try to meet the heavy lifting we've asked of them and also to wish everybody a happy holiday Merry Christmas anyone else okay dr. Coons bring us home and then we will adjourn please I just want to thank the board over the past year we've really worked

[03:29:31] on our regulatory reduction and Jim Chapman and his staff have just done Herculean efforts to update our regs which were significantly behind and our tech team in the back who constantly every time we get assigned to a new room figure out how to make it work and and ensure that we can meet our live streaming and public needs to really appreciate them but also over the past year the board has leaned in to recognizing educators recognizing schools bringing bright spot schools to the board and I really appreciate the opportunity to bring our schools into the board and into the board conversations

[03:30:10] that means a great deal and then also our emphasis on fine arts over the past year by bringing students and bringing performances to remind us of what we're doing so I just want to thank the board for all of that hard work there was a statement made about standard setting and I want to comment on that as we close as Virginia shifts to an improved assessment system aligned to the recommendations of the House Bill 585 workgroup video is working closely with national experts also known as our Technical Advisory Committee which has been a part of the department work for multiple decades the Technical Advisory

[03:30:49] Committee includes national experts and they ensure that our high quality assessments are aligned to what students need to know and be able to do in each grade and be proficient our Technical Advisory Committee of experts met last month to discuss the alignment of the assessment system with the new reading and math standards as well of implementation of new test item types for the 585 report their

recommendation was to complete the standard setting process which is also known as cut scores setting after this year's assessment cycle is concluded it is expected

[03:31:25] that the department will launch the standard setting process later in the spring of 2025 and per the board's request we will bring that formal update in february thank you so much president creasy okay and with that i'm not sure i've we've reached a record today at 12 20 but um i will um entertain a motion to adjourn okay we're adjourned

